THE SUMMONER

DRAW STEEL



MCDM

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Version 1.0b

Greetings, my fledgling summoners. I, *High Summoner* Willy, have called you all forth to witness the tenth heroic class of *Draw Steel*!

The summoner evokes a wide variety of different fantasies in the "I have more than one homie" category. Particularly in games, it's also come to encompass big cost creature-flavored spells and shapeshifting characters, which ... those sound weird when you read it out loud, right? A lot of the funnier instantiations of the summoner you've seen were born out of fitting the fantasy into a preexisting game system in a way that hits all the right notes without upending how the game plays as a whole.

It's been a long road leading up to this supplement. For years, I've chased down a rock-solid design for a summoner class within a turn-based multiplayer tactics game. My ideal ruleset has evaded me in tabletop, but games in *other* form factors have done it! I could come up with examples across real-time games, card games, and single player games with a strong and satisfying take on the fantasy, so it *had* to be possible. I've scribbled down littles notes and rules for different summoner approaches on and off but never had enough time and space to pull it off.

Fast-forward to the MCDM design team trying to determine the last classes to add to the *Draw Steel* core rules. By this point, we had the concept of the summoner utilizing the minion squad rules, but minions wouldn't have their numbers dialed in until late into production, which meant there wouldn't be time to test a class using those rules. We only had enough time and testing to confidently implement nine heroic classes, and it was too risky to add the summoner into the list.

But once *Draw Steel* released, we finally had enough time and space to pull it off.

The *Draw Steel* summoner is our first **master class**. It was created in conversation with *Draw Steel*'s rules and assumes you know how the game works before flipping them on its head. This means that while you're still playing *Draw Steel*, the summoner handles very differently from the elementalist, the talent, or any of the core nine classes. We want to make sure you're ready for it before diving in. I don't imagine there will be too many other master classes in the future, but only the chronopath knows what's in store for our game.

You might not be familiar with the combat roles this summoner is suited for. Hell, *I* didn't know until after its first major playtest! That, and the sudden supply of minions on the field will probably be a shock whether you play a hero or a Director. We have some advice at the end of this supplement that should reduce the number of surprises and bring you up to speed, but here's the best guidance I can give you upfront: Give yourself the time and space to play with the summoner, and it'll start to click before you know it.

I think what I'm looking forward to the most is what you'll do with the summoner. It's exciting to think about people not just getting used to the system, but really making it their own, you know? You'll find minion combos that we never could've imagined. You'll reopen the "ethical necromancy" debate. You might even be inspired to tweak the summoner system to make it simpler and more efficient at your table (or perhaps *more* complex if you're a sicko)!

Good luck and have fun!

Willy Abeel
MCDM Senior Game Designer
High Summoner of the Circle of Fools

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THE SUMMONER

The process by which essence, the ambient energy of creation, can be channeled and focused to pierce the veil between worlds and summon biddable creatures, is obscure. Deliberately hidden by those who master it.

In principle, summoning should be no more difficult to learn than elementalism, since the two disciplines both manipulate essence. In practice, there is obviously some difference, as elementalists are relatively common, while summoners are vanishingly rare.

While there are known incidents of summoners who learned their craft through study alone, most apprentice themselves to a mentor. Mentors are both hard to find and typically recalcitrant. Many supplicants are rejected. Many who are accepted fail their first test. By tradition summoners guard their knowledge jealously.

Each summoning discipline has its own loose affiliation of practitioners called circles. Most members of a summoning circle know only two or three other members. A circle has no centralized leadership, no agreed-upon meeting place. One may go months or years without meeting another member. But information makes its way among them. Even the far-flung practitioners of the summoning arts enjoy their gossip.

Tradition holds the necromantic circle, the **Circle of Graves** is the oldest. Summoning undead from the Necropolitan Ruin, the City at the Bottom of the Timescape. The elemental circle, the **Circle of Storms**, may be the most numerous, summoning elemental motes from Quintessence, the plane of all elements.

While the Circle of Graves certainly enjoys a sinister reputation, the demonologists of the **Circle of Blight**, also known as the Circle of the Wasteland, summon demons from the Abyssal Waste. One may argue that animating a soulless carcass is a morally neutral act. No such argument exists to defend those who summon the armies of that wasted land.

Finally, the **Circle of Spring**—celebrated and benign, lauded in folklore and often mistaken for elementalists—call forth fey animations from Arcadia, the home of Val, god of the elves.

There are rumors of another organization of summoners, though whether it exists and, if it exists, what it calls itself is not well-known. Rumors and folklore hold that membership in this fifth circle is permitted only to the most powerful summoner from the other four circles. If this circle exists, it may be called the **Eidos Circle**, or the Eidos Society.

Essence, it seems, cannot impart or touch a soul. This much is known. The animations summoners pull from places like the Necropolitan Ruin or Arcadia have the semblance of life, sometimes even personalities, but these attitudes are like a recording. Programming. Pixies and sprites speak, but they seem to repeat the same stock phrases. They do not appear to think novel thoughts or create. There are, at the last, limits to the power of essence.

On Summoning

He obeyed two masters. The one who loved him. The one he protected. Would protect with his life. And she protected him. Beyond certainty, he knew they would protect each other. In every way that mattered, she was the other half of him.

And the other. The one he feared. The one with power. The one who burned with hate. This one too, he must obey. Their relationship was complex, the three of them. Sometimes his two masters fought, barked at each other, much anger, and he knew it was his place to sit and watch. When the barking was over, there would be purpose, and he would make them proud. They were a good team.

Sometimes the barking got very loud, and then very quiet. And the one who loved him would go away, and he would follow. They would be alone together, sometimes for so long he forgot about the dark master. But eventually she would return, or the dark one would find them, and it was as though nothing had happened.

It was like this with families.

But always he knew there was a crisis ahead. He couldn't see it, but he felt it. He took pride in being a servant of the dark master. Pleasing him was difficult, but the pride he felt afterwards …

And he knew the dark master cared for him, as well as his other master. But there was something else inside that one. The hate. He knew: someday the hate would take over.

He wondered if his other master knew this.

He stared at the corpse at his feet. He looked around the clearing. No tracks, no sign of activity. No obvious way the corpse got here. No sign of struggle or clear method of termination.

He looked up. Through the canopy of emerald green he saw white clouds float past a cerulean sky. He saw the shape, the depth of the clouds like massive flying cities. *The world contains beauty enough. And miracles*, he thought. He took a deep breath, the smells of the forest filled his lungs.

He looked down at the dead peasant. *And mysteries enough. And horrors.* He imagined himself as standing somewhere between the two. *But,* he noted, prodding the corpse with his boot, *certainly closer to one than the other.*

His herald was nowhere to be seen. This was not unusual after a row. He would not compel a servant to stay if he knew doing so might force them to leave and never return. Even his tyranny had its limits.

He crouched, using his staff for support, reached out, and touched his fingertips to the corpse's face where it pressed into the rich earth. The corpse juddered for a moment, movements mechanical, not organic, then something like a sigh escaped its mouth.

He stood and ordered his thoughts. When he was young, the power filled him and he leapt at whatever question popped into his mind, wasting precious moments. Now he was older. Much older. He held more than power now—he held wisdom. He knew that broad questions, even vague, left room for answers that were more enlightening.

"How camest thou to this place?" he said in the old formulation his circle taught. It wasn't required, but it was traditional.

Without moving, lips slack, not forming words, sound emerged from the corpse's mouth. This was a routine occurrence for him, no longer did his skin crawl, no longer did he hold his breath.

"The twilight children," a woman's voice said, and it echoed as though coming from deep within a cave. "The arrows. My family."

Wheels spun in his mind, a look of intense concentration on his broken face. He sensed, he *knew* from her response he had asked the right question. But her words were more a key than an answer. He filed it away and pressed on.

"Setati," he said. "Priestess of the Boatman." It was not a question—it was a prompt. Let the corpse respond how they saw fit.

"Urged us. To stay. We should not. Have left. But we could not. Have stayed."

He nodded. Took a deep breath. *We're on the right track.* He pushed his thin hair in streaks of black and white out of his face.

When first granted this power by the Circle, he would chase down as many answers as he could get before the window closed. But that just filled his mind with fog. Answers became just more questions. Now he was a master, and knew it was better to let the conversation take its natural course. Do not press the issue.

He asked a final question, the least important. Almost trivial. He was sure he had what he needed already.

The voice came, faint. This would be the last answer. "I was Gwir Pawley," then only a whisper. "I am Gwir Pawley."

This startled him and he spoke aloud. "I was," he quoted and looked around the forest, the trees, the outcropping of rock as though they might answer. "I am."

Mysteries enough, he thought, and stroked his chin. At the edge of his reason, he thought he glimpsed something like an answer. But his worldlore was weak in this category.

He scanned the clearing once again, still no sign of his herald. He pursed his lips and closed his eyes, drawing himself up.

Muttering in the first language, he opened a channel to one who might know. His mentor said it would only work locally, recently. But he had gone beyond the knowledge of the circle, he had already learned much denied to others. His powers were more ... complicated.

Calmness came over him. Serenity. Rest. Warmth. Home. He gritted his teeth, these feelings were unwelcome.

A smell. The smell of her hair, her clothes. Almost he heard the sound of song. A lullaby.

The old woman walked into his body. His face softened. His eyes opened, and she saw. His lips moved, and her voice emerged.

"Oh my child," her voice said. It was nothing like the voice of the corpse, it was alive. "My darling boy look at you. I would that you were free from this obsession that has its claws around your soul."

His face contorted, and was his again.

"Is this an area of bilocation?" he asked.

His features softened, his eyes sad. He shook his head. "The gods were wise when they made the world," the old woman's voice said. "The burden of life is too great to bear for more than a small span of years."

He clenched his fist, untrimmed nails bit into pale flesh. "Is this," he repeated, "an area. Of bilocation?"

She sighed. He would not be denied. "Yes," she said, and now when his face changed, he was smiling a knowing smile. He nodded. "I thought so," he said. "A wode?"

She needed no more prompting. His power had mastered her, and she must answer. She was, he knew, more lorewise than he would ever be.

"No," she said. "Not a wode. But no longer just a forest. It is something else. It is becoming."

The channel cost more than effort to maintain. He had the lore he needed. "Becoming," he said, and relaxed. Letting the woman's spirit rest again. He felt her reach out to him, attempt to embrace him as she faded. He ignored her. "Becoming what?" he wondered aloud.

"Become your *death!*" a feral voice barked.

He glanced over his shoulder and noted there were five hobgoblins at the edge of the clearing. What was this weakness of pride that caused ones such as these to announce themselves when an unannounced assault might have had a chance?

Only five meant it was a knife—a patrol. There would be a fist nearby with its own death captain. That would be a problem. But not this.

The hobgoblins' ancient pact which birthed their species made them, in his opinion, *better* than either goblins or humans. He admired them. It was a shame these would be dead in a moment.

"Another straggler!" said one of the infernal devil-goblin hybrids, a female. "At this rate we'll kill their whole village! One lost stray at a time!" The other hobgoblins laughed and sneered at this, but the one who spoke first, the one who announced himself, was peering at the dark-robed human in the center of the clearing.

"You interrupt me in my work," the human said, his voice calm. "Remove yourself."

"Remove ...!" said the female, incredulous. She hefted her long spear and looked at her commander. "Allow me, Vhorag! This one is beneath you!"

Vhorag was wiser than his eager soldier, and hesitated, sensing the presence of power before him. The lancer saw this as permission and howled as she charged. The others immediately followed.

Inside him, always now, there was a door. And pressure, things on the other side desperate for release, desperate to serve. To serve him. All he had to do ... was allow it.

He gestured with a hand and a row of iron bars festooned with sharp metal spikes jutting out at all angles shot up out of the ground in front of the hobgoblin lancer. She and her cohort slammed into the cold iron, and the bits of corpses, hands, arms, that decorated the bars reached out, grasping. All the warmth of the forest in summer fled, and cold, cold from the deep, spread out from the iron gate.

The hobgoblin lancers stood in terror. Their commander barked an order in their native tongue and turned to flee, leaving his terrified soldiers behind.

As soon as he turned, the earth shook. Once, twice, then a thing, a creature, loomed out of the forest.

A giant. Small for a giant, but a giant nonetheless, it bent two trees apart to make room, and the sounds of their trunks snapping were twin thunderclaps.

The hobgoblin commander barked something at the giant. An order? Whatever it was, the giant could not hear. Would not obey.

For the giant was longdead. And now in the thrall of a greater power.

With speed it never possessed in life, the giant snatched the hobgoblin commander up off the ground and, using both its rotting fists, tore the commander in half. Scalding, bright-red blood erupted from the screaming body, burning into the giant zombie's flesh.

It took no notice. It stepped forward and with a stomp, crushed two lancers. The other two turned in fear to flee but, forgetting the iron gate behind them, immediately impaled themselves on its spikes.

The hobgoblins now all dead, the giant dropped the legs and lower half of the commander from its left hand, and then plucked the head off the torso in its right. It worked the head for a moment, first popping the helmet off, then scraping as much flesh off as it could.

It stepped over the iron gate, and bent down to deliver the skull, covered in blood and bits of flesh, to its master. The iron gate sank into the ground.

"Thank you," he said, and held the skull before him, turning it this way and that. A mediocre specimen.

The giant zombie bowed, then sunk into the earth that birthed it. Leaving a wide carpet of fresh earth where once there was grass and vines.

For a moment the clearing was silent again. Carrion beasts would come and take advantage of the fresh corpses eventually.

He heard footsteps running toward him, twigs snapping under feet and two figures burst into the clearing. A young woman with a longspear ready for battle, and a magnificent beast as large as a horse. Feline, seemingly white, but in fact possessed of a mantle that rippled through many hues one could see if one looked closely. Its eyes took in everything with keen, seeking intelligence. It did not roar, did not announce itself. But seeing only corpses and the dark master, it sat on its haunches.

The girl ran to him and the beast loped along with her. She was alert, agitated, but the beast was relaxed. Whatever happened here was over.

"I'm sorry," she said, frantic. "I ... we smelled blood and found a trail of it." She looked at the red corpses littering the clearing. "We thought it might be hobgoblins." Her head snapped up to look at him, worried. "Master, what does it mean?! If these creatures are hunting the villagers they may already be ...!"

He snapped his fingers at her, once. It sounded like a whip crack. Her back stiffened involuntarily, she brought herself under control.

Mastering herself, she got down on one knee and bowed her head. The great beast beside her sat on its haunches and did the same.

"My lord," she said. "Your herald bids you. Command me."

THE SUMMONER CLASS

You are the armada. The kings of old would trade armies for your abilities. You've undertaken the tradition that conjures an endless supply of warriors. You are the summoner, the mage who takes their dreams and makes them manifest.

You call forth minions to trudge fearlessly into the fray and provide support, holding the enemy at bay while you and your fellow heroes ready the counteroffensive. Your minions serve unflinchingly, unerringly, to their death or to yours.

You can also take advantage of powerful magic to buff your allies, whittle down your enemies, or enlist the fallen into your ranks. And when push comes to shove, you can call upon your champion to finish the fight.

Basics

Starting Characteristics: You start with a Reason of 2, and you can choose one of the following arrays for your other characteristics scores:

- 2, 2, –1, –1
- 2, 1, 1, –1
- 2, 1, 0, 0
- 1, 1, 1, 0

Weak Potency: Reason – 2

Average Potency: Reason – 1

Strong Potency: Reason

Starting Stamina at 1st Level: 15

Stamina Gained at 2nd and Higher Levels: 6

Recoveries: 8

Skills: You gain the Magic and Strategy skills and can choose any two skills from the intrigue or lore skill groups. (*Quick Build:* Eavesdrop, Magic, Monsters, Strategy.)

Draw Steel Master Classes

The summoner is an example of a master class in *Draw Steel*. Master classes are intended for players who are familiar with the game and have played a few sessions already. They are not recommended for first time players—you need to know the rules before we start breaking them on you!

If you are new to *Draw Steel*, we recommend checking out *The Delian Tomb* starter adventure, which includes a step-by-step tutorial on how to play the game and breaks down all the working parts of a hero. Save Broadhurst first, and then you hurry back here!

1st-Level Features

As a summoner, you gain the following features.

Summoner Circle

You've learned the art of summoning from a member of a loose network of summoners called a circle. Each circle specializes in a distinct portfolio of creatures you can call into existence. Choose a summoner circle from the following options, each of which grants you a communication feature (*Quick Build:* Circle of Graves.)

Circle of Blight: You are a demonologist who calls forth demons from the Abyssal Waste. Your portfolio includes shapechanging demons that grow in hunger and power over time. You can communicate with creatures that have the Abyssal keyword even if you don't share a language.

Circle of Graves: You are a necromancer who raises undead creatures from the Necropolitan Ruin. The corporeal and incorporeal creatures under your command are hardy and many. You can communicate with creatures that have the Undead keyword even if you don't share a language.

Circle of Spring: You are a feybright who beckons pixies, nixies, and sprites from Arcadia. Your portfolio features ephemeral fey spirits surrounded by weird and powerful magic. You can communicate with creatures that have the Fey keyword even if you don't share a language.

Circle of Storms: You are a storm caster who summons elementals from Quintessence. This portfolio contains forces of nature that leave a big impact on the environment. You can communicate with creatures that have the Elemental keyword even if you don't share a language.

Your choice of circle decides the portfolio from which you summon minions, as well as many of the features you'll gain from this class. Your circle is your subclass.

Summoner Advancement

Level	Summoner Features	Circle Features	Minions	Abilities
1st	Minions, Essence, Summoner Strike, Strike For Me, Minion Bridge, Formation, Quick Command, Summoner Abilities	Summoner Circle, Circle Features, Portfolio	1, 1, 3, 3	5
2nd	Perk	Summoner's Dominion, New Portfolio Minion	1, 1, 3, 3, 5	5
3rd	Summoner's Kit, 7-Essence Ability		1, 1, 3, 3, 5	5, 7
4th	Characteristic Increase, Minion Improvement, Essence Salvage, Minion Chain, Perk, Skill		1, 1, 3, 3, 5	5, 7
5th	—	Circle Feature, New Portfolio Minion	1, 1, 3, 3, 5, 7	5, 7
6th	Perk, Minion Machinations, Kit Improvement, 9-Essence Ability	Return to the Source	1, 1, 3, 3, 5, 7	5, 7, 9
7th	Characteristic Increase, Minion Improvement, Font of Creation, Their Life for Mine, Skill	—	1, 1, 3, 3, 5, 7	5, 7, 9
8th	Perk	Circle Feature, Portfolio Champion	1, 1, 3, 3, 5, 7, 9	5, 7, 9
9th	Kit Improvement, Steward of Two Worlds, 11-Essence Ability	—	1, 1, 3, 3, 5, 7, 9	5, 7, 9, 11
10th	Characteristic Increase, Minion Improvement, Eidos, No Matter the Cost, Among Our Ranks, Perk, Skill	—	1, 1, 3, 3, 5, 7, 9	5, 7, 9, 11

Minions

The creatures you control are called **minions**. You can summon and maintain up to a maximum of 8 minions. Your minions are considered allies at your level.

You can manage up to two **squads** of minions. Newly summoned minions can either be organized into a new squad or be distributed into other squads under your control. A squad can't contain more than eight minions, and all minions in the squad must have the same name.

The maximum distance that you can summon minions and use specific conjuring abilities is called your **Summoner's Range**. Your Summoner's Range is equal to 5 + your Reason score. You must have line of effect to summon and give commands to minions within your Summoner's Range. Commanding a minion to take a main action or a maneuver while hidden reveals you.

You also have special minions at your disposal called **signature minions**, low-cost creatures that you've become accustomed to summoning often. See Portfolio for more details about the types of minions you can summon.

Minions in Combat

Start of Combat: At the start of a combat encounter or some other stressful situation tracked in combat rounds (as determined by the Director), you can summon up to two of your signature minions at no cost into unoccupied spaces within your Summoner's Range (no action required).

Start of Turn: At the start of each of your turns during combat, you can summon up to three of your signature minions at no cost into unoccupied spaces within your Summoner's Range (no action required).

Summoning: Each minion is summoned on the ground unless they can fly or hover. Unless an ability specifies, you can't summon any new minions beyond your minion maximum until the same number of existing minions are dismissed or destroyed.

Stamina: Minions in a squad pool their Stamina together. Whenever a minion in a squad takes damage, the squad's Stamina pool is reduced by a number equal to the damage taken. Each time the pool is reduced by an amount equal to a single squad member's Stamina, one minion dies (starting with the minion that took damage, followed by the next nearest minion). If there is any excess damage after all minions in the squad are dead, you take damage equal to 2 + your level. Minions can't be winded, can't regain Stamina, and can't gain temporary Stamina.

Area Effects: The damage from an area effect dealt to a squad's Stamina pool can only kill up to the minions in its area. Any excess damage is ignored.

Strikes with Multiple Targets: A squad's Stamina pool only takes the largest single instance of damage from a strike that targets two or more minions in that squad. Any additional effects still affect the minions targeted by the strike.

Conditions: You resolve any saving throws on conditions affecting one or more of your minions. Treat saving throws as if you had one instance of each condition.

Immunity and Weakness: If any minion in a squad has damage immunity or weakness to a particular damage type, apply that effect to the entire squad only once, regardless of how many minions share the same trait.

Actions: Minions in a squad act together on your turn in any order, before, in-between, and/or after any of your actions. They can either take a move action and a main action (excluding Heal and Defend), a move action and a maneuver, or two move actions. Individual minions can also make opportunity attacks.

Free Strikes: Unless otherwise specified, a minion's free strike has a distance of Melee 1 or Ranged 5 and deals the damage value listed on the stat block. The minion can choose to deal untyped damage or the damage type next to the damage value.

Damage: Whenever multiple minions strike the same target simultaneously, the damage is added together and treated as a single strike. Minions in a squad targeting the same target with a signature ability only apply one instance of the signature ability while each additional minion increases the damage by a number equal to their free strike value.

Surges: Your minions share your pool of surges and can apply them to their strikes. Whenever one or more of your minions would gain a surge during a turn, you gain that surge instead.

Maneuvers: Unless otherwise specified on the minions' stat block, a squad uses their maneuver together as a unit. If a maneuver targets a single creature, all minions in the squad target the same creature. If a maneuver requires a power roll, the result is equal to 8 + the minions' characteristic + the number of squad members within distance of the maneuver.

Individual Maneuvers: An individual minion can use a maneuver to alleviate their own circumstances, such as getting up from prone or escaping a grab. If they do, they can't take part in their squad's main action or maneuver.

Characteristics: Your minions have their own characteristics for the purposes of resisting potencies, maneuvers, and making tests. You use your own characteristics where a minion's stat block refers to an R or uses a potency (such as M<WEAK).

Unconscious: If you are unconscious or unable to act on your turn, you can't summon new minions. Additionally, your remaining minions can't deal damage; they can only act to bring you to safety.

End of Combat: At the end of combat, your minions finish their tasks (such as carrying someone to safety) and are then dismissed.

Minions Outside of Combat

While outside of combat, you can have up to 4 minions summoned without spending essence. You can freely summon your signature minions this way. For other minions, while you have a number of Victories equal to the minion's essence cost or more, you can summon up to the set number of minions listed on their stat block.

Each of your minions can be given a simple task and a destination you've previously visited and they'll fulfill it to the best of their ability. Example tasks include sending messages, scouting, and carrying supplies. Your minions aren't followers and can't make project rolls until you can summon specialists (see Minion Machinations).

When combat begins, any of your minions who were summoned outside of combat finish their tasks and are then dismissed.

Soul-y Moley!

Your minions are manifestations of the magic you weave and don't harbor any souls of their own. They are expressions of your own soul and are more akin to dreams than sapient creatures.

Treat your minions as if they had your soul whenever they are targeted by abilities that affect souls. Ignore any effects that trigger when a creature with a soul dies unless you're the one being targeted.

Essence

You and your minions have a unique reserve of **essence** as your Heroic Resource. You use this magic to sculpt your forces and maintain control over the battlefield.

Essence in Combat

At the start of a combat encounter or some other stressful situation tracked in combat rounds (as determined by the Director), you gain essence equal to your Victories.

At the start of each of your turns during combat, you gain 2 essence. The first time each round that any minion (either yours or an enemy) dies unwillingly within your Summoner's Range, you gain 1 essence.

Whenever you use a heroic ability or call forth a minion that costs essence, you can willingly sacrifice one or more of your minions within your Summoner's Range to reduce the cost by 1. You can't kill minions this way if they used a main action or maneuver during the turn. You can sacrifice more minions than you would reduce the cost by.

You lose any remaining essence at the end of the encounter.

Essence Outside of Combat

Though you can't gain essence outside of combat, you can use your heroic abilities and effects that cost essence without spending it. Whenever you use an ability or effect outside of combat that costs essence, you can't use that same ability or effect outside of combat again until you gain at least 1 Victory or finish a respite.

More Wielders of Quintessence

Essence is the "stuff of creation." Just as the elementalist uses essence to conjure fire, lightning, or warp space and time, the summoner uses essence to manifest skeletons, conjure pixies, and call forth demons from the Abyssal Waste.

There may be more magicians in the future that also rely on essence for their magic.

Summoner Strike

You have the following ability, which replaces both your melee and ranged free strikes.

Summoner Strike

A sudden burst of energy erupts from your implement and shocks your foes' nerves.

Magic, Melee, Ranged, Strike — **Main action**

Melee 1 or Ranged 5 — One creature or object

Effect: R damage. If the target has R<WEAK, they are slowed (save ends).

Special: This ability has the Charge keyword when it's used as a melee strike.

Strike For Me

You have the following free triggered action.

Strike for Me

Your minions fight in your stead.

Magic, Ranged — **Free triggered**

Summoner's Range — Each of your minions

Trigger: You use a triggered action to make a free strike or use a signature ability.

Power Roll + Reason:

≤11 Up to three targets each make a free strike

12–16 Up to five targets each make a free strike

17+ Up to seven targets each make a free strike

Special: On a natural 19 or 20, each target makes a free strike.

Effect: Your minions act in place of you making a free strike or using a signature ability. If you were granted the triggered action against a specific target, your minions must strike the same target. If the triggered action granted you a signature ability, you have an edge on the power roll.

Your Minions Deal the Damage

By normal *Draw Steel* rules, everyone gets access to free strikes. As a summoner, you have a free strike equivalent in addition to minions who have their *own* free strikes. Changing how you attack allows your minions to shine in battle while keeping your damage output in line with your fellow heroes. The static damage you and most of your minions deal also keeps your turns fast and flowing.

Call Forth

You have the following ability.

Call Forth (1+ Essence)

My power is yours, and yours, mine. I summon thee.

Magic, Ranged — **Main action**

Summoner's Range — Self

Effect: You summon one or more minions from your portfolio into unoccupied spaces within distance. Choose one of the following options:

Signature Minions: You summon one signature minion for each essence you spend on this ability.

All Other Minions: You summon the set number of minions listed on the stat block for their essence cost.

Minion Bridge

You have the following maneuver.

Minion Bridge
Your minions do everything in their power to form a safe path for you to cross.

Magic | **Maneuver**
Melee 1 | One of your minions

Effect: You shift into a square adjacent to the target, including vertically.

You can shift into squares that contain one of your minions, even if they occupy difficult terrain. Each time you shift into a square that contains one of your minions while using this maneuver, you can shift an additional square.

1 Essence: An adjacent ally can shift alongside you during this movement. They must end their movement in an unoccupied square adjacent to the last minion you moved through.

1st-Level Circle Features

Your circle grants you features as shown on the 1st-Level Summoner Circle Features table.

1st-Level Summoner Circle Features

Circle	Feature
Blight	Death Snap, Soulsense
Graves	Dead Men Tell All Tales, Rise!
Spring	Fairy Whispers, Pixie Dust
Storms	Elemental Affinity, Heart of Nature

Dead Men Tell All Tales

You can touch the corpse of a creature who died within the past week and ask them a question. The corpse can choose to answer the question to the best of their ability. Each additional question you ask the corpse requires a **medium Reason test**, where failure or consequence breaks your connection with the corpse permanently.

The corpse can also choose to refuse to answer or lie, especially if you were the one to kill them in the first place.

Death Snap

Whenever one of your demon minions would die unwillingly, they can deal damage to an adjacent creature equal to their free strike value before dying.

Elemental Affinity

Whenever you use Call Forth to summon one or more non-signature elemental minions, you can summon one bonus signature minion at no cost. You can choose between a signature minion that shares an Element keyword with the minions you summoned (such as Fire, Earth, or Air) or an elemental mote.

Fairy Whispers

Whenever you send a minion to perform a task for you outside of combat, they can bring back a rumor from the destination to which you sent them. When the minion returns, make a **Reason test**:

- ≤11 You learn an undoubtedly false common rumor.
- 12–16 You learn a common rumor that is most likely true.
- 17+ You learn an obscure rumor that could either be true or false.

You gain a bane on the test for each subsequent rumor you collect either on the same day or in the same location.

Heart of Nature

You can sense the presence of creatures with the Elemental or Dragon keywords within 1 mile of you. You can innately feel their emotions or pain, and you can't obtain lower than a tier 2 outcome on any Intuition test made to socially interact with them.

Pixie Dust

Increase your number of Recoveries by 2.

Whenever one of your fey minions dies within your Summoner's Range, you can spend a Recovery to give temporary Stamina equal to twice your Reason score to each non-minion ally adjacent to the minion when they died.

Rise!

Once per round, when a creature dies unwillingly within your Summoner's Range, you can use a triggered action to summon a signature undead minion in their space at no cost, even if you're at your minion maximum, but only if they can be organized into one of your squads. The new minion can't act until the start of your next turn.

This ability becomes a free triggered action if the target was a minion (either yours or an enemy).

Soulsense

While you have line of effect to a creature with a soul, you can perceive a trail of where the creature has been in the last number of minutes equal to 5 × your level.

When you finish a respite, you can always perceive the soul trails of each creature that took the respite with you until your next respite.

Formation

You've practiced a specific formation for your minions. Choose one of the following formations: horde, platoon, elite, or leader. You can change your formation along with your quick command (see Quick Command) by performing intense study as a respite activity. (*Quick Build:* Platoon Formation.)

Horde Formation

Your maximum number of minions increases by 4 and you summon up to four of your signature minions at the start of each of your turns instead of three.

Platoon Formation

Whenever one of your squads uses a damaging ability, choose one target of that ability to take additional damage equal to your Reason score.

Elite Formation

Each of your minions have their Stamina increased by 3 and their stability increased by 1.

Leader Formation

You aren't affected by excess damage after all minions in a squad are dead. If your minion is within your Summoner's Range when they take damage, you can choose to take damage in place of the minion.

Additionally, you can use light armor treasures and light weapon treasures while you don't have a kit.

Minions and Treasures

Treasures in *Draw Steel* are typically worded for you to use, which might create ambiguity for a summoner managing an army. You can use the following guidelines to ensure the treasures you come across in your adventures do what they were intended to do.

- Treasures that give you a damage bonus to rolled damage only apply to power rolls made from a non-minion's space. However, when you use Strike for Me, any bonus damage is applied to each enemy and object that took damage.
- Once you reach level 4 as a summoner, you regain access to your normal free strike abilities while wielding a weapon treasure, an implement treasure, or any treasure that enables you to make a free strike as a part of its effect.
- Treasures that increase the distance of ranged magic abilities also increase the distance of your Summoner's Range.

Quick Command

You have a special command you can issue to your minions. Choose one of the following quick commands. You can change your quick command along with your formation (see Formation) by performing intense study as a respite activity. (*Quick Build:* Shield!)

Focus Fire!

You have the following triggered action.

Focus Fire!
You ensure the enemy can't escape the incoming attack.

— | **Triggered**
Summoner's Range | Self or one ally

Trigger: The target deals damage to another creature.
Effect: The target gains a surge for each of your minions adjacent to them (up to a maximum of 3 surges), which they can use on the triggering damage.
Spend 1 Essence: If the triggering damage is from an ability that uses a power roll, the power roll gains an edge.

Halt!

You have the following triggered action.

Halt!
You order a minion to get in the way.

— | **Triggered**
Summoner's Range | One creature

Trigger: The target starts their turn, moves, or is force moved.
Effect: You summon a signature minion in an unoccupied space adjacent to the target. If the target is force moved into the minion, you can choose to make the target take no damage from the collision.
Special: Instead of summoning a new minion, you can command one of your minions within distance to shift up to their speed toward a square adjacent to the target before any additional effects occur.

Not Yet!

You have the following triggered action.

Not Yet! (3 Essence)
I command you to not die.

— | **Triggered**
Summoner's Range | One ally

Trigger: The target receives enough damage to die or be destroyed.
Special: If the target is a minion, they must be the only minion remaining in their squad.
Effect: The damage the target receives is reduced by an amount that leaves the target alive with 1 point of Stamina.

Shield!

You have the following triggered action.

Shield!
You call upon a minion to use their body to dampen the blow.

— | **Triggered**
Summoner's Range | Self or one ally

Trigger: The target is targeted by a strike.
Effect: If one of your minions is adjacent to the target and is within distance of the strike, they become the new target of the strike.
Spend 1 Essence: Instead of commanding an existing minion, you summon a signature minion into an unoccupied space adjacent to the target to take the strike.

Portfolio

Your portfolio comprises the minions you've learned to summon. Each summoner circle specializes in a portfolio of creatures with which the summoner can build their armies, as shown on the Summoner Circle Portfolio table. Your circle allows you to select minions to add to your own portfolio.

Summoner Circle Portfolio

Circle	Portfolio
Blight	Demon Portfolio
Graves	Undead Portfolio
Spring	Fey Portfolio
Storms	Elemental Portfolio



Demon Portfolio Signature Minion

Select two of the following signature minions. Signature minions are summoned at the start of combat and at the start of your turn for free. You can also use Call Forth to summon any number of signature minions for their essence cost.

Ensnarer

This vaguely humanoid form is warped and distorted by a demon nestled inside them. They extend long tongues from multiple orifices to drag victims in close.

Ensnarer
Abyssal, Demon
Signature Minion Brute
1 essence per minion summoned

1M	5	2	0	2
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: —
Weakness: Holy 1
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +2	**Agility** 0	**Reason** -1	**Intuition** -1	**Presence** -1

★ **Extended Barbed Strike**
The ensnarer's melee free strikes have a distance of 3 and inflict pull 1. The pull distance increases by 1 for each additional ensnarer striking the same target. Choose the ensnarer that the target is being pulled to before applying forced movement.

★ **Soulsight**
Each creature adjacent to the ensnarer can't be hidden from them.



Rasquine

The rasquine are skulking demons that shimmer in the light. They teleport into position before biting the necks of their prey.

Rasquine
Abyssal, Demon
Signature Minion Ambusher
1 essence per minion summoned

1S	4	2	0	2
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: Teleport
Weakness: Holy 1
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might -1	**Agility** 0	**Reason** -1	**Intuition** -1	**Presence** +2

★ **Skulker**
Once per turn, the rasquine can hide as a free maneuver after teleporting.

★ **Soulsight**
Each creature adjacent to the rasquine can't be hidden from them.

Razor

Razors appear to be a diminutive variant of the ruinant demon. Their bodies are swift, tumbling mounds of scarred flesh and deadly claws.

Razor
Abyssal, Demon
Signature Minion Harrier
1 essence per minion summoned

1M	6	2	0	1
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: —
Weakness: Holy 1
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might 0	**Agility** +2	**Reason** -1	**Intuition** -1	**Presence** -1

★ **Teeth!**
Once per turn, whenever an adjacent enemy grabs the razor or uses a melee ability against them, that enemy takes 1 damage for each razor adjacent to them.

★ **Soulsight**
Each creature adjacent to the razor can't be hidden from them.

Demon Portfolio 3-Essence Minion

Choose two of the following minions. You can use Call Forth to summon the listed number of 3-Essence minions for their essence cost.

Archer Spittlich

These minor demons resemble larger pitlings. They can spit a nerve-numbing phlegm at long distance that makes it easy to catch their next meal.

Archer Spittlich — **Minion Artillery**
Abyssal, Demon — 3 essence for two minions

1S	5	5 | 5	2	5
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: —
Weakness: Holy 1
Free Strike Damage Type: Poison

Might 0	**Agility** +2	**Reason** -1	**Intuition** -1	**Presence** 0

★ **Splash Strike**
The spittlich's ranged free strikes have a distance of 10 and deal 2 poison damage to an enemy adjacent to the target. Creatures that take poison damage from this spittlich can't shift until the start of the spittlich's next turn.

★ **Soulsight**
Each creature adjacent to the spittlich can't be hidden from them.

Fanged Musilex

Ensnarers knot and twist their bodies together to form heaving, heavy musilexes. They're compelled to drag everything in toward their body.

Fanged Musilex — **Minion Brute**
Abyssal, Demon — 3 essence for two minions

1L	6	6 | 6	1	5
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: —
Weakness: Holy 1
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +2	**Agility** +1	**Reason** -1	**Intuition** -1	**Presence** 0

★ **Mawful Strike**
The musilex's melee free strikes have a distance of 2 + R and inflict pull 2. The pull distance increases by 2 for each additional musilex striking the same target. Choose the musilex that the target is being pulled to before applying forced movement. If the target is pulled adjacent to the musilex, the musilex either deals an additional 2 damage or grabs them.

★ **Soulsight**
Each creature adjacent to the musilex can't be hidden from them.

Twisted Bengrul

The bengrul is an undulating heap of glass and flesh. They shatter pieces of themselves to disrupt senses and inflict grisly wounds on their prey.

Twisted Bengrul — **Minion Hexer**
Abyssal, Demon — 3 essence for two minions

1L	5	5 | 5	1	4
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: —
Weakness: Holy 1
Free Strike Damage Type: Psychic

Might +2	**Agility** +1	**Reason** -1	**Intuition** -1	**Presence** 0

Mind Twist 2d10 + R — **Signature Ability**
Magic, Ranged, Strike — Main action
Ranged 5 — One creature or object per minion

≤11 — 4 damage; P<WEAK twisted (save ends)
12-16 — 6 damage; P<AVERAGE twisted (save ends)
17+ — 8 damage; P<STRONG twisted (save ends)

Effect: A twisted target can't take advantage of edges or search for hidden creatures until the condition ends.

★ **Soulsight**
Each creature adjacent to the ensnarer can't be hidden from them.





Elemental Portfolio Signature Minion

You gain the **elemental mote** and can choose one of the following signature minions. Signature minions are summoned at the start of combat and at the start of your turn for free. You can also use Call Forth to summon any number of signature minions for their essence cost.

Elemental Mote

This near-pure form of autonomous essence just barely maintains their form. They can shift their nature to match their surroundings.

Elemental Mote — **Signature Minion Hexer**
Elemental — 1 essence per minion summoned

1T	5	1	0	1
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: Fly
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might 0	**Agility** 0	**Reason** 0	**Intuition** 0	**Presence** +2

★ **Dweomer Burst**
When the mote is reduced to 0 Stamina, each enemy adjacent to the mote has a bane on their next strike.

★ **Catalyst**
Once per turn, the mote can transform into an adjacent allied signature minion, maintaining their current Stamina. The minion must be reassigned to a new squad if their new name differs from the other squad members.
Alternatively, you can spend 1 essence to transform the mote into any signature minion in the elemental portfolio you don't have, as if you summoned the new minion into the mote's space.

Brisk Gale

The gales are twisting ribbons of cloud and debris endlessly dancing in place. They disrupt the air and allow their allies to move freely.

Brisk Gale — **Signature Minion Harrier**
Elemental (Air) — 1 essence per minion summoned

1S	5	2	0	1
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Sonic R
Movement: Fly
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Sonic

Might -2	**Agility** +2	**Reason** 0	**Intuition** 0	**Presence** +1

★ **Cutting the Air**
The gale doesn't provoke opportunity attacks by moving.

★ **Whirlwind**
When the gale is reduced to 0 Stamina, winds whip in their space until the end of the encounter. You or an ally that enters this space or starts their turn there can immediately shift (including vertically).

Fire Plume

A fire plume burns so bright that their true shape is hard to discern from the flames. They sputter and spit motes of fire in high arcs.

Fire Plume
Elemental (Fire)

Signature Minion Artillery
1 essence per minion summoned

1T	5	1	0	2
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Fire R
Movement: —

Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Fire

Might -2	**Agility** +1	**Reason** 0	**Intuition** 0	**Presence** +2

★ **Spitfire Strike**
The plume's ranged free strikes have a distance of 10.

★ **Pyre**
When the plume is reduced to 0 Stamina, their space becomes wreathed in flames until the end of the encounter. An enemy that enters this space or starts their turn there takes 2 fire damage.

Walking Boulder

These massive clods of animated stone roll upon smaller piles of rocks that could be perceived as limbs. Walking boulders are useful for taking up space and forming barricades.

Walking Boulder
Elemental (Earth)

Signature Minion Defender
1 essence per minion summoned

2	4	3	R	1
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: Climb

Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +2	**Agility** -2	**Reason** 0	**Intuition** 0	**Presence** +1

★ **Obstruct**
The boulder obstructs line of effect for enemies.

★ **Pile Up** **1 Essence**
When one or more boulders is reduced to 0 Stamina, they each leave behind a stone wall equal to their size in their space until the end of the encounter.

Traits with an Essence Cost

Some minion stat blocks have traits that can only be activated if you spend the heroic resource listed in the top corner of the trait. For example, when a **crux of ash** is reduced to 0 Stamina, you can spend 1 essence to use their **Ashen Cloud** trait.



Elemental Portfolio 3-Essence Minion

Choose two of the following minions. You can use Call Forth to summon the listed number of 3-Essence minions for their essence cost.

Crux of Ash

The crux is a curtain of billowing hot ash with an avian head. They cover their victims in a burning cloak of charcoal and soot.

Crux of Ash
Elemental (Fire, Air)
Minion Ambusher
3 essence for two minions

1M	5	6 | 6	0	5
Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike

Immunity: Fire R, sonic R
Movement: Fly
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might -2	Agility -2	Reason 0	Intuition 0	Presence +1

Soot Strike
The crux's melee free strikes M<AVERAGE automatically hide each ally from the target until the start of the crux's next turn, until the target uses a maneuver to clear the soot, until the crux takes damage, or until the crux is destroyed.

Ashen Cloud **1 Essence**
When the crux is reduced to 0 Stamina, the area within 1 square of the crux is clouded by ash until it is dispersed by wind. You or any ally are concealed while occupying an affected square. An enemy can't establish line of effect beyond the ash while occupying an affected square.



Flow of Magma

This elemental is a long, serpentine creature of heated rock. Flows of magma drool trails of lava from their fangs after biting their prey.

Flow of Magma
Elemental (Fire, Earth)
Minion Harrier
3 essence for two minions

1L	5	6 | 6	2	4
Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike

Immunity: Fire R
Movement: Climb
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Fire

Might +2	Agility -2	Reason 0	Intuition 0	Presence +1

Molten Strike 2d10 + R
Magic, Melee, Strike
Melee 2
Signature Ability
Main action
One creature or object per minion
≤11 4 fire damage; shift 3
12-16 6 fire damage; shift 4
17+ 8 fire damage; shift 5
Effect: Each square that the flow shifts into becomes wreathed in flames until the start of the flow's next turn. An enemy that enters an affected square takes 2 damage.

Eruption **1 Essence**
When the flow is reduced to 0 Stamina, they launch lava into an area equal to 1 + their size within 5 squares. The affected area becomes difficult terrain for enemies until the end of the encounter. An enemy that enters an affected square or starts their turn there takes A<AVERAGE 4 fire damage.

Desolation of Sand

The desolations have vaguely humanoid sand forms with no legs. Their glass hose "arms" shift and bristle before firing high pressure streams of sand at their foes.

Desolation of Sand
Elemental (Air, Earth)
Minion Hexer
3 essence for two minions

1M	5	5 | 5	1	4
Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike

Immunity: Sonic R
Movement: Burrow
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +1	Agility +2	Reason 0	Intuition 0	Presence -2

Burying Strike
The desolation's free strikes inflict M<AVERAGE slowed (save ends). If the target is already slowed, then they are M<STRONG restrained (EoT).

Sand Through Your Fingers
The desolation doesn't provoke opportunity attacks by moving.

Shifting Sand Pit **1 Essence**
When the desolation is reduced to 0 Stamina, the area within 1 square of the desolation becomes difficult terrain for enemies until the end of the encounter. You or an ally that enters the affected area can immediately shift 3.



Fey Portfolio Signature Minion

Select two of the following signature minions. Signature minions are summoned at the start of combat and at the start of your turn for free. You can also use Call Forth to summon any number of signature minions for their essence cost.

Nixie Soakreed

These nixies are especially tiny. Their hair grows longer than their bodies and curls into reeds. The water soakreeds swim in tends to turn thick and cling to surfaces.

Nixie Soakreed — **Signature Minion Controller**
Fey — 1 essence per minion summoned

1T	5	1	0	1
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: Swim
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might -2	Agility -1	Reason 0	Intuition +2	Presence +1

★ **Water Weird**
Once per turn during their move action, each nixie under your control can teleport to a body of water within 5. The soakreed can't teleport into water created by their own soaking bog.

★ **Soaking Bog**
The area within 1 square of the soakreed is filled with swampy water. An enemy that starts their turn in the area is **A < WEAK** slowed (EoT). The potency increases by 1 for each additional soaking bog the target occupies (maximum +2).

★ **Minuscule**
The soakreed has cover while occupying a larger creature's space.

Pixie Bellringer

The bellringers are glowing pixies that jingle as they fly. Historically, these pixies worked alongside bowman to ensure their arrows struck true.

Pixie Bellringer — **Signature Minion Support**
Fey — 1 essence per minion summoned

1T	5	2	0	1
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: Fly, hover
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might -3	Agility +1	Reason 0	Intuition 0	Presence +2

★ **Ringing Strike**
The bellringer's free strikes grant an edge to the next strike made against the target, or a double edge if two or more bellringers strike the same target.

★ **Fairy Chime**
Each ally within 1 square of a bellringer has a +1 to saving throws. Each enemy within 1 square of a bellringer has a –1 to saving throws.

★ **Minuscule**
The bellringer has cover while occupying a larger creature's space.



Sprite Dandeknight

Dandeknights are sprite warriors whose dragonfly wingbeats emit a tonal drone. They're usually clad in tassels that shift color as they swing their weapons.

Sprite Dandeknight — **Signature Minion Harrier**
Fey — 1 essence per minion summoned

1T	6	2	0	1
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: Fly
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +2	Agility 0	Reason -1	Intuition -1	Presence -1

★ **Magic Strike**
When the dandeknight strikes, you can choose one of the following damage types: acid, cold, corruption, fire, lightning, poison, or sonic. The strike deals that damage.

★ **Staccato Swings**
When the dandeknight makes a free strike, they can make two free strikes instead. The damage is added together and treated as a single strike if both strikes hit the same target.

★ **Minuscule**
The dandeknight has cover while occupying a larger creature's space.

Fey Portfolio 3-Essence Minion

Choose two of the following minions. You can use Call Forth to summon the listed number of 3-Essence minions for their essence cost.

Pixie Hydrain

This pixie flies on a delicate array of vibrant flower petals for wings. The color drains from their wings as they call forth acid rain showers.

Pixie Hydrain
Fey
Minion Artillery
3 essence for two minions

1T	5	5 | 5	0	5
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Acid R
Movement: Fly, hover
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Acid

Might -3	Agility 0	Reason +1	Intuition 0	Presence +2

Burning/Healing Rain 2d10 + R
Signature Ability
Magic, Ranged, Strike
Main action
Ranged 5
One creature or object per minion

≤11 5 acid damage; M < WEAK weakened (EoT)
12-16 7 acid damage; M < AVERAGE weakened (EoT)
17+ 9 acid damage; M < STRONG weakened (save ends)

Effect: After the hydrain's squad uses this ability, you or one ally within distance can spend a Recovery or end a condition.

★ **Minuscule**
The hydrain has cover while occupying a larger creature's space.

Pixie Loftlilly

Loftlillies lazily drift through the air in flower cups. They sip on toxic nectar to emit a powerful haze from their skin.

Pixie Loftlilly
Fey
Minion Controller
3 essence for two minions

1T	5	5 | 5	0	4
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Poison R
Movement: Fly, hover
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Poison

Might -2	Agility +1	Reason 0	Intuition 0	Presence +2

★ **Floating Toxins**
The area within 1 square of the loftlilly causes each enemy and object with a size equal to your Reason or smaller to float 1 square off the ground until they leave the area. A floating enemy that can't fly is unable to shift, moves 2 additional squares from forced movement, and has a bane on strikes.

★ **Minuscule**
The loftlilly has cover while occupying a larger creature's space.

Sprite Orchiguard

The orchiguard is a sprite surrounded by a wheel of shields. They are usually crushed by the pressures of their own impenetrable defenses before ever being felled by enemy hands.

Sprite Orchiguard
Fey
Minion Defender
3 essence for two minions

1S	6	8 | 8	2	4
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: Fly
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +2	Agility 0	Reason -1	Intuition -1	Presence -1

★ **Fairy Guard**
Each non-orchiguard ally takes half damage from abilities while within 1 square of the orchiguard. Whenever the orchiguard reduces damage this way, they take damage equal to half their maximum Stamina and their free strike damage increases by 1.

★ **Minuscule**
The orchiguard has cover while occupying a larger creature's space.



Undead Portfolio Signature Minion

Select two of the following signature minions. Signature minions are summoned at the start of combat and at the start of your turn for free. You can also use Call Forth to summon any number of signature minions for their essence cost. (*Quick Build:* Skeleton, Husk.)

Husk

Husks have stiff corpses that snap and crackle with each sudden movement. Corrosive breath endlessly billows from their slackjawed faces.

Husk
Undead

Signature Minion Defender
1 essence per minion summoned

1M	5	3	1	1
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Damage 2, corruption R, poison R
Movement: —
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Corruption

Might +2	**Agility** 0	**Reason** -1	**Intuition** -1	**Presence** -1

★ **Rotting Strike**
The husk's melee free strikes inflict M<WEAK slowed (EoT). The potency increases by 1 for each additional husk adjacent to the target (maximum +2).

Shrieker

The shrieker expresses their unending pain in a way that can be heard and felt for miles. A white-hot fire smolders within each of their sunken eye sockets.

Shrieker
Undead

Signature Minion Artillery
1 essence per minion summoned

1M	4	1	0	2
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption R, poison R
Movement: —
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Sonic

Might -2	**Agility** -2	**Reason** 0	**Intuition** 0	**Presence** +2

★ **Howling Strike**
The shrieker's ranged free strikes have a distance of 12.

★ **Shrill Alarm**
Each enemy within 2 squares of the shrieker can't hide or be hidden.

Skeleton

These autonomous bone networks fall just short of replicating the structure they had in life. Skeleton bones are especially brittle and can splinter into huge shards when met with enough force.

Skeleton
Undead

Signature Minion Harrier
1 essence per minion summoned

1M	6	2	0	1
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption R, poison R
Movement: —
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +2	**Agility** 0	**Reason** -1	**Intuition** -1	**Presence** -1

★ **Bonetrops**
When the skeleton is reduced to 0 Stamina, their square becomes difficult terrain for enemies. The first time any enemy enters this space, they take 2 damage and end this effect.



Undead Portfolio 3-Essence Minion

Choose two of the following minions. You can use Call Forth to summon the listed number of 3-Essence minions for their essence cost. (*Quick Build:* Stalker Shade, Grave Knight.)

Grave Knight

The grave knights are zombie warriors that continue to fight after death. Any blood spilled at a grave knight's hand runs pitch black.

Grave Knight — **Minion Brute**
Undead — 3 essence for two minions

1M	6	6 | 6	1	5
Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike

Immunity: Corruption R, poison R
Movement: —
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +2	Agility +1	Reason 0	Intuition 0	Presence +1

Knight Strike 2d10 + R — **Signature Ability**
Melee, Strike, Weapon — Main action
Melee 1 — One creature or object per minion

- ≤11: 5 corruption damage; M<WEAK bleeding (EoT)
- 12-16: 7 corruption damage; M<AVERAGE bleeding (EoT)
- 17+: 9 corruption damage; M<STRONG bleeding (save ends)

To the Grave
When the grave knight is reduced to 0 Stamina, they can make a melee free strike before being destroyed.

Stalker Shade

Shades are a form of umbral stalker that float free from any floor or surface. They can bend their appearance to completely vanish in the light.

Stalker Shade — **Minion Ambusher**
Undead — 3 essence for two minions

1M	5	6 | 6	1	5
Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike

Immunity: Corruption R, poison R
Movement: Fly, hover
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Corruption

Might -2	Agility +1	Reason 0	Intuition 0	Presence +2

Shadow Strike
The stalker shade turns invisible, shifts 3 squares, and reappears after making a strike.

Shadow Phasing
The stalker shade can move through other creatures and objects at normal speed. The first time in a round that the stalker shade passes through a creature, that creature takes 2 corruption damage. The stalker shade doesn't take damage from being force moved into objects.





Zombie Lumberer

These massive, animated ogre corpses still maintain their incredible grip strength. When a lumberer falls, they'll take anything within reach down with them.

Zombie Lumberer
Undead

Minion Defender
3 essence for two minions

2	5	8 | 8	R	1
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption R, poison R
Movement: —
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +2	**Agility** -2	**Reason** 0	**Intuition** 0	**Presence** +1

★ **Zombie Clutch**
The lumberer's melee free strikes inflict A < AVERAGE grabbed. A creature or object that starts their turn grabbed by the lumberer takes corruption damage equal to your Reason.

★ **Death Grasp**
When the lumberer is reduced to 0 Stamina, they can latch onto an adjacent enemy before being destroyed. The enemy is M < STRONG restrained (EoT).

Summoner Abilities

Your own abilities focus on support and enable you to position and outfit your allies for success.

Heroic Abilities

Breaking down your essence into pure power can lead to devastating effects. Your heroic abilities enable you to punctuate your army's efforts.

5-Essence Ability

Choose one heroic ability from the following options, each of which costs 5 essence to use. (*Quick Build:* Rallying Cry.)

Essence Transfer (5 Essence)
You pierce your foe and repurpose some of that 'fiber of their being' they weren't using.

Magic, Melee, Strike — **Main action**
Melee 1 — One creature

Power Roll + Reason:
≤11 5 + R corruption damage; 2 charges (see below)
12-16 8 + R corruption damage; 3 charges
17+ 11 + R corruption damage; 4 charges

Effect: You can spend charges to activate one of the following effects. You can activate an effect multiple times. All charges disappear after using this ability.

- **1 charge:** You or an ally within your Summoner's Range can spend a Recovery.
- **1 charge:** You or an ally within your Summoner's Range gain a surge.
- **2 charges:** You call forth a signature minion into an unoccupied space within your Summoner's Range.

Explosive Parade (5 Essence)
Your minions swell with energy until they can no longer exist in this realm.

Magic, Ranged — **Main action**
Summoner's Range — Special

Power Roll + Reason:
≤11 You summon four signature minions.
12-16 You summon five signature minions.
17+ You summon six signature minions.

Effect: The minions are summoned within distance regardless of your minion maximum and without organizing them into squads. Each newly summoned minion immediately moves up to their speed toward a creature or object.

If they move adjacent to their target, become targeted by an opportunity attack, or stop moving, they explode, dealing 2 damage to one adjacent creature or object and pushing them 1 square. If a target is affected by two or more minions' explosions, the effects stack. These minions activate no effects upon death, and you gain no essence from their deaths.

Special: In addition to the minions summoned as a part of this ability, you can choose to command any number of your minions within distance, provided they haven't used a main action or maneuver during the turn.

Distraction Tactics (5 Essence)

Your minions do the work to draw the heat away from your allies.

Magic **Free maneuver**
Self Special

Effect: Until the end of the encounter or until you are dying, each minion under your control during the encounter is the target of the following effect:

The target's strikes can inflict I<WEAK taunted (EoT) to enemies. The potency increases by 1 for each minion that joined the strike.

Rallying Cry (5 Essence)

"Show them what you're made of!"

Magic, Ranged **Maneuver**
3 burst All Allies

Effect: Each target chooses between gaining 2 surges or dealing additional damage equal to your Reason on their next strike.

Shields of Essence (5 Essence)

You call forth protective forces to keep you all from harm.

Magic, Ranged **Maneuver**
Summoner's Range Special

Power Roll + Reason:
≤11 Three creatures
12-16 Four creatures
17+ Five creatures

Effect: Until the end of the encounter, each target can use a free triggered action whenever they take damage to reduce the incoming damage by half and then lose this effect.

Summoner's Sword (5 Essence)

You draw your strength from the army you surround yourself with and summon a hot blade of energy and fervor.

Magic, Melee, Strike **Main action**
Melee 3 One creature or object

Power Roll + Reason:
≤11 R damage
12-16 2 + R damage
17+ 4 + R damage

Effect: This strike deals an additional 2 damage for each ally adjacent to you.

2nd-Level Features

As a 2nd-level summoner, you gain the following features.

Perk

You gain an intrigue, lore, or supernatural perk of your choice. See **Perks** in *Draw Steel: Heroes* for more information.

Summoner's Dominion

Your circle allows you to call forth a piece of your portfolio's dominion like any minion.

Once per encounter, you can use a maneuver to summon a fixture from your minions' native manifold or origin into an unoccupied space on the ground within your Summoner's Range. You can spend 1 essence to relocate the fixture as a free maneuver on your turn. The fixture stays until the end of the encounter, until its Stamina is reduced to 0, or until you become dying.

Your fixture gains additional features at 5th and 9th level.

Demon Portfolio Fixture

The boil arises from the chaotic depths of the Abyssal Waste, concentrated into a heaving mass by the pressure of a coherent reality. As it slushes and threatens to burst, the noises drive nearby demons into a frenzy.

The Boil — Hazard Support

Stamina: 20 + your level **Size:** 2

★ **Hunger Thrush**
Each enemy that starts their turn within 3 squares of the boil is I<AVERAGE taunted (EoT) by the boil, or I<WEAK taunted (EoT) by the boil and can't move further from it.

★ **Oh, It Pops**
When the boil is destroyed, each enemy within 3 squares of the boil takes acid damage equal to your level and is A<STRONG weakened (save ends).

Level 5 Fixture Advancement Feature

★ **Soul Rancor**
You gain a surge the first time in a round that your demon minions deal 3 or more damage to a creature while you have line of effect to the boil. You can choose to give the surge to an ally who also has line of effect to the boil.

Level 9 Fixture Advancement Feature

★ **Size Increase**
The boil is now size 3.

★ **Fester Field**
Each non-abyssal enemy that starts their turn within 3 squares of the boil takes 5 corruption damage.

Elemental Portfolio Fixture

The storm of elements from Quintessence coalesce into a hardened, crystalline structure. It magnifies the elemental composition of any matter that passes through it and emits supernatural colors while doing so.

Primordial Crystal — Relic Artillery

Stamina: 20 + your level **Size:** 2

★ **Magnetic Pull**
Each enemy that starts their turn within 3 squares of the crystal is vertically pulled 3.

★ **Elemental Boost**
When you or an ally uses a ranged ability that draws a line through the crystal, the distance increases by 5.

Level 5 Fixture Advancement Feature

★ **Terra Resonance**
Each round, you gain a surge the first time an area of terrain gains a supernatural effect (excluding auras) while you have line of effect to the crystal. You can choose to give the surge to an ally who also has line of effect to the crystal.

Level 9 Fixture Advancement Feature

★ **Size Increase**
The crystal is now size 3.

★ **Magnified Strike**
When you or an ally makes a ranged strike that draws a line through the crystal, the user gains a surge which they can use on the ability.

Fey Portfolio Fixture

The vibrant waters of Arcadia pour through a hole in reality and pool into a verdant cup of paradise. As the pond babbles, it causes the surrounding flora to grow and provides the fey places to hide.

Glade Pond — Hazard Ambusher

Stamina: 20 + your level **Size:** 2

★ **Bubbling Boost**
You and each non-minion ally that enters one or more squares within 3 squares of the pond or starts their turn there has their speed increased by 2 until the end of their turn.

★ **Overgrowth**
Each of your fey minions that ends their turn within 3 squares of the pond is hidden until the start of their next turn.

Level 5 Fixture Advancement Feature

★ **Garden of Jest**
You can spend a Recovery the first time in a round a creature gains or starts their turn with a condition while you have line of effect to the pond. Alternatively, you can choose to enable an ally who also has line of effect to the boil to spend a Recovery instead.

Level 9 Fixture Advancement Feature

★ **Size Increase**
The pond is now size 3.

★ **Folly Field**
Each non-fey enemy that starts their turn within 3 squares of the pond has a –1 penalty to saving throws and resisting potencies until the start of their next turn.

Undead Portfolio Fixture

Tall iron gates from the Necropolitan Ruins arise from the earth as wailing spirits swirl around its bars. The undead refuse to stop moving while near the threshold of oblivion.

Barrow Gates — Fortification Defender

Stamina: 20 + your level **Size:** 2

★ **The Bell Tolls**
Each enemy that starts their turn within 3 squares of the gates is I < AVERAGE frightened (EoT) by the gates. The potency increases by 1 for winded enemies.

★ **Undead Dominion**
Each of your undead minions has damage immunity 2 while occupying a space within 3 squares of the gates.

Level 5 Fixture Advancement Feature

★ **Memento Mori**
You gain a surge the first time in a round one of your undead minions unwillingly dies while you have line of effect to the gates. You can choose to give the surge to an ally who also has line of effect to the gates.

Level 9 Fixture Advancement Feature

★ **Size Increase**
The gates are now size 3.

★ **Open the Gates**
You can use Rise! as a free triggered action each time an enemy dies within 3 squares of the gates while you have line of effect to the gates.

New Portfolio Minion

Your circle allows you to select new minions to add to your portfolio.

Demon Portfolio 5-Essence Minion

Choose one of the following minions.

Gushing Spewler

A spewler's mouth makes up most of its size. They unleash torrents of acid and bile from their pitless stomachs before consuming their prey with bag-like maws.

Gushing Spewler
Abyssal, Demon
Minion Controller
5 essence for three minions

1M	5	4 | 4 | 4	0	3
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: —
Weakness: Holy 1
Free Strike Damage Type: Acid

Might -2	**Agility** 0	**Reason** -1	**Intuition** +3	**Presence** +3

★ **Gushing Strike**
The spewler's ranged free strikes have a distance of 10 and slides the target R + 2 squares.

★ **Spew Slide**
Each time the spewler takes damage, the spewler shifts 2 after all effects resolve. Each square they exit during this movement is covered in slime until the end of the encounter. An enemy has a bane on strikes while occupying a slimed square.

★ **Soulsight**
Each creature adjacent to the spewler can't be hidden from them.

Hulking Chimor

Chimors have no true shape; their bodies restructure and change endlessly. Pieces of the chimor demon snap off inside their prey, causing their bodies to also restructure from the inside out.

Hulking Chimor
Abyssal, Demon
Minion Defender
5 essence for three minions

2	5	7 | 7 | 7	3	3
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: —
Weakness: Holy 1
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +3	**Agility** 0	**Reason** +2	**Intuition** +1	**Presence** +1

★ **Mercurial Strike**
The chimor's melee free strikes inflict M<WEAK weakened (EoT). The potency is increased by the current round number.

★ **Evershifting**
The chimor doesn't provoke opportunity attacks by moving.

★ **Soulsight**
Each creature adjacent to the chimor can't be hidden from them.



Violent

The violents are lanky, oily bipeds with bright red flesh that contort and snap their bodies into unassuming objects. Their mimicry is particularly precise, to the point where it's unclear whether their victims die from the surprise or the violent transformation process first.

Violent
Abyssal, Demon
Minion Ambusher
5 essence for three minions

1M	7	5 | 5 | 5	1	4
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: Climb
Weakness: Holy 1
Free Strike Damage Type: Corruption

Might +2	**Agility** +3	**Reason** 0	**Intuition** -1	**Presence** -1

★ **Transforming Strike**
The violent's melee free strikes deal an additional 2 damage to each adjacent enemy from whom they were hidden. The violent loses their disguise after striking.

★ **Mimicry**
The violent uses the Hide maneuver at the start of their turn as a free maneuver, disguising themselves as a a size 1M or smaller object.

★ **Soulsight**
Each creature adjacent to the violent can't be hidden from them.

Elemental Portfolio 5-Essence Minion

Choose one of the following minions.

Dancing Silk

The silks are akin to baby spiders ballooning through the air on strands of webbing. They spin silk from their legs as they fly, eventually turning huge swaths of the environment into tangled web mazes.

Dancing Silk — **Minion Controller**
Elemental (Earth, Air, Green) — 5 essence for three minions

Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike
1T	5	4 | 4 | 4	0	3

Immunity: Poison R
Movement: Fly
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might	Agility	Reason	Intuition	Presence
-1	+2	+3	0	-1

★ **Entangling Strike**
The silk's ranged free strikes inflict A<AVERAGE restrained (EoT). Each creature adjacent to the target is A<WEAK slowed (EoT).

★ **Web** — **1 Essence**
When the silk is reduced to 0 Stamina, they launch ribbons of webbing into an area equal to their size + 1 within 5 before being destroyed. The affected area is considered difficult terrain for enemies until the end of the encounter. An enemy that ends their turn in the webbing is M<STRONG slowed (EoT).

Principle of the Swamp

The manes of these equine sludge dwellers extend and hook into things like strong, fraying arms. This allows the principle of the swamp to either pull themselves onto dry land, or pull their prey into the dank depths.

Principle of the Swamp — **Minion Brute**
Elemental (Green, Water, Rot) — 5 essence for three minions

Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike
2	4	5 | 5 | 5	R	4

Immunity: Corruption R, poison R
Movement: Swim
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might	Agility	Reason	Intuition	Presence
+3	-2	0	+2	-2

★ **Encroaching Strike**
The principle's melee free strikes have a distance of R and inflict M<STRONG grabbed. The principle can have an unlimited number of creatures or objects grabbed. A creature grabbed by this strike still has their normal speed, but can't move farther away from the principle.

★ **Sludgefoot** — **1 Essence**
When the principle is reduced to 0 Stamina, the area within 1 square of the principle becomes difficult terrain for enemies until the end of the encounter. An enemy that ends their turn in the affected area is pulled 4 toward the center of the area.

Quiet of Snow

This elemental is a pure-white vulpine with six legs that freely sprints through the air. Their howls are telepathic, washing over the receivers with a strong chill and a wave of goosebumps.

Quiet of Snow — **Minion Artillery**
Elemental (Air, Rot, Water) — 5 essence for three minions

Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike
1S	5	4 | 4 | 4	1	4

Immunity: Sonic R, cold R
Movement: Fly, hover
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Cold

Might	Agility	Reason	Intuition	Presence
-1	+2	0	0	+3

Freezing Howl 2d10 + R — **Signature Ability**
Magic, Ranged, Strike — Main action
Ranged 5 — One creature or object per minion

≤11 — 4 cold damage; M<WEAK slowed (EoT)
12-16 — 6 cold damage; M<AVERAGE slowed (EoT)
17+ — 8 cold damage; M<STRONG speed is 0 (EoT)

Effect: Frost slows the enemy down, allowing one ally adjacent to each target to shift 2 and either hide or defend.

★ **Cold Surge**
When the quiet is reduced to 0 Stamina, they launch a refreshing blast of air into an area equal to their size + 1 within 5 before being destroyed. Each ally in the affected area gains a surge.

Fey Portfolio 5-Essence Minion

Choose one of the following minions.

Nixie Hemloche

Hemloches are spotted nixies whose long, wavy hair endlessly bobs and flows into the water surrounding them. Any sailor caught in a whirlpool created by hemloches knows that their ship won't survive the encounter.

Nixie Hemloche — **Minion Hexer**
Fey — 5 essence for three minions

1T	6	4 | 4 | 4	0	3
Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike

Immunity: —
Movement: Swim
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Lightning

Might -2	Agility 0	Reason +1	Intuition +3	Presence +2

Water Weird
Once per turn during their move action, each nixie under your control can teleport to a body of water within 6. The hemloche can't teleport into water created by their own whirling waves.

Whirling Waves
The area within 1 square of the hemloche is filled with churning water and is considered difficult terrain. At the end of the hemloche's turn, the hemloche can choose to slide each enemy in the affected area 3 squares. An enemy that takes damage while being force moved is also M<AVERAGE knocked prone.

Minuscule
The hemloche has cover while occupying a larger creature's space.

Sprite Foxglow

Foxglows are masked sprites that leave behind an evanescent trail of tiny glowing orbs as they fly. They beat their wings at a frequency that completely blocks out all nearby noise.

Sprite Foxglow — **Minion Ambusher**
Fey — 5 essence for three minions

1T	8	5 | 5 | 5	0	4
Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike

Immunity: Fire R
Movement: Fly
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Fire

Might -1	Agility +3	Reason 0	Intuition +1	Presence +2

Flash Strike
The foxglow's melee strikes inflict I<STRONG dazed (EoT) if they were hidden when they make the strike.

Quiet Flight
The area within 2 squares of the foxglow is completely silent. Each enemy has a bane on tests made to search for the foxglow and allies hidden in the affected area.

Minuscule
The foxglow has cover while occupying a larger creature's space.

Pixie Rosenthall

The collective of blood-eyed pixie warriors that make up a rosenthall are also known as rosies. It's said that some rosenthall armies contain thousands of pixies and can span half the length of a wode.

Pixie Rosenthall — **Minion Harrier**
Fey, Swarm — 5 essence for three minions

2	6	5 | 5 | 5	1	3
Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike

Immunity: —
Movement: Fly, hover
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might 0	Agility +2	Reason +4	Intuition 0	Presence +3

Stickerbush Symphony 2d10 + R — **Signature Ability**
Melee, Strike, Weapon — Main action
Melee 2 — One creature or object per minion

≤11: 3 damage; pull 2; A<WEAK bleeding (EoT)
12–16: 6 damage; pull 3; A<AVERAGE bleeding (EoT)
17+: 8 damage; pull 4; A<STRONG bleeding (EoT)

Effect: A target can't shift while bleeding from this ability.

Swarm
The rosenthall can move through squares as if they were size 1T, and can occupy other creatures' spaces. At the start of the rosenthall's turn, they deal 2 damage to each enemy whose space they share.



Undead Portfolio 5-Essence Minion

Choose one of the following minions.

Accursed Mummy

The preserved dead, bound for eternal rest, know only violence when robbed of their future. Accursed mummies use their wrappings to bind others to the same fate.

Accursed Mummy — **Minion Hexer**
Mummy, Undead — 5 essence for three minions

1M	5	4 | 4 | 4	2	3
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption R, poison R
Movement: —
Weakness: Fire 1
Free Strike Damage Type: Poison

Might +2	Agility -1	Reason +1	Intuition +3	Presence -1

Fetid Bindings 2d10 + R — **Signature Ability**
Melee, Strike, Weapon — Main action
Melee R — One creature or object per minion

≤11 — 3 poison damage; pull R
12-16 — 4 poison damage; pull R + 1
17+ — 6 poison damage; pull R + 2

Effect: A target pulled adjacent to the mummy is M<STRONG weakened (EoT).

Mummy Dust
Whenever the mummy takes damage, each enemy adjacent to the mummy takes 2 poison damage.

Ceaseless Mournling

Mournlings are hulking amalgams of mismatched cadavers with tear-stained trenches where their cheeks used to be. Their crying shakes enemies to their bone and renders them struggling to move.

Ceaseless Mournling — **Minion Controller**
Undead — 5 essence for three minions

2	4	4 | 4 | 4	R	3
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption R, poison R
Movement: Burrow
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Sonic

Might +3	Agility +2	Reason -1	Intuition +1	Presence -2

Always Crying
At the end of the mournling's turn, each enemy within 1 of the mournling takes 2 sonic damage and can't shift until the start of the mournling's next turn.

Immutable Form
The mournling's shape can't change via any external effects.

Rupture
The first time the mournling burrows out of the ground on their turn, they can make a free strike against each adjacent enemy.

Phase Ghoul

Phase ghouls are bilocated undead caught between two different manifolds, rapidly flickering between them. They almost appear transparent save for their long, bright blue tongues that appears to lag behind their movements by a full second.

Phase Ghoul — **Minion Harrier**
Undead — 5 essence for three minions

1M	5	5 | 5 | 5	0	3
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption R, poison R
Movement: Teleport
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +2	Agility +3	Reason -2	Intuition 0	Presence +1

Leaping Strike
The ghoul teleports 5 squares before making a melee free strike. The target is M<AVERAGE knocked prone. If the target is in the air, the potency increases by 1.

Nerveless
The ghoul takes no damage from falling and always lands on their feet.

3rd-Level Features

As a 3rd-level summoner, you gain the following features.

Summoner's Kit

You conjure a kit for yourself. This kit includes an implement, such as a rod or a baton, which grants you the following benefits:

- The damage of your Summoner Strike ability increases to twice your Reason score.
- The potency of your Summoner Strike ability increases to R < AVERAGE.
- The distance of your Summoner Strike ability is now equal to your Summoner's Range.

Your kit also comes with wards like magic armor and transient minion forces. Choose one of the following wards.

Conjured Ward

You are clad in the natural defenses of your portfolio (bones, fairy wood, stone, writhing flesh). You gain a +3 bonus to Stamina and that bonus increases by 3 at 4th, 7th, and 10th levels.

Emergency Ward

The first time each round you take damage, you can use a free triggered action to shift 1 after the triggering effect resolves and summon a signature minion into the square you left (as long as there is enough space).

Howling Ward

You create a 1-aura vortex of slicing magic around you when you enter combat. An enemy that starts their turn adjacent to you takes damage equal to your Reason.

Snare Ward

Whenever an adjacent creature deals damage to you, you can use a free triggered action to pull that creature toward one of your minions within your Summoner's Range a number of squares equal to your Reason score.

7-Essence Ability

Choose one heroic ability from the following options, each of which costs 7 essence to use.

Blitz Tactics (7 Essence)

Rush 'em! CRUSH 'EM!

Magic | **Free maneuver**
Self | Special

Effect: Until the end of the encounter or you are dying, each minion under your control during the encounter is the target of the following effect. The first time on a turn that the target moves through an enemy's space, the enemy can choose to shift 1 square or be M < WEAK (or M < AVERAGE if the target is larger than the enemy) knocked prone. The potency increases by 1 for each subsequent target that moves through the enemy's space during the same move action.

Cavalry Call (7 Essence)

A lone squad appears to disrupt the enemy's plans and peels off their forces, one by one.

Magic | **Main action**
Summoner's Range | Special

Effect: You summon a temporary squad containing 6 of your signature minions regardless of your minion maximum within distance. Whenever one of these minions deals damage to an enemy, the enemy is R < AVERAGE compelled to move 5 squares toward the source of the damage (provoking opportunity attacks). The potency increases by 1 for enemies targeted by two or more of these minions.

These minions die at the end of your turn, activate no effects upon death, and you gain no essence from their deaths.

Essence Funnel (7 Essence)

You rapidly summon and sacrifice minions in order to power a devastating blast of magic.

Area, Magic | **Main action**
10 × 1 line within 1 | Each enemy and object in the area

Power Roll + Reason:

≤11 5 damage; push 2
12–16 9 damage; push 4
17+ 12 damage; push 6

Special: You can choose to kill any number of your minions within your Summoner's Range as a part of this ability, provided they haven't used a main action or maneuver during the turn. Each target takes an additional 1 damage, plus 1 damage for each minion killed this way. These minions activate no effects upon death, and you gain no essence from their deaths.

Lead By Example (7 Essence)

Your minions watch as your implement crackles with power, ready to slam unbelievable force into your foe.

Magic, Melee, Ranged, Strike | **Main action**
Melee 1 or Summoner's Range | One enemy or object

Power Roll + Reason:

≤11 8 + R damage; R < WEAK dazed (save ends)
12–16 12 + R damage; R < AVERAGE dazed (save ends)
17+ 16 + R damage; R < STRONG dazed (save ends)

4th-Level Features

As a 4th-level summoner, you gain the following features.

Characteristic Increase

Your Reason score becomes 3. Additionally, you can increase one of your characteristic scores by 1, to a maximum score of 3.

Minion Improvement

Your maximum number of minions increases by 4.

You can increase each of your minions' Stamina as shown on the 4th-Level Minion Stamina Increase table. Additionally, each minion that receives a Stamina boost can treat their characteristics as one higher for the purposes of resisting potencies (to a maximum value of 3).

These benefits are not reflected in the stat blocks of new minions you acquire.

4th-Level Minion Stamina Increase

Minion	Stamina Increase
Signature Minion	Stamina +1
3-Essence Minion	Stamina +3
5-Essence Minion	Stamina +2

Essence Salvage

The first time each combat round that any minion unwillingly dies within your Summoner's Range, you gain 2 essence instead of 1.

Minion Chain

Whenever you use Minion Bridge as a maneuver, each of your minions within your Summoner's Range can shift up to their speed before the maneuver takes effect, as long as each minion that shifts ends their movement adjacent to another one of your minions.

Additionally, your minions can chain themselves together to function as a ladder or a swinging rope. When your minions move as a part of using Minion Bridge, each minion can use this movement to shift into a position directly beneath another one of your minions, hoisting them and each other minion they have hoisted, until they form a chain. The chain can then choose to fall across an unoccupied space and/or the topmost minion grabs an object to keep the chain steady.

The chain lasts until the start of your next turn or until the chain is no longer steady. The chain can also end when a minion in the chain is destroyed or when you command your minions to let go as a free maneuver. All size 1 minions count as one square when determining the chain's length.

Perk

You gain any one perk of your choice. See **Perks** in *Draw Steel: Heroes* for more information.

Skill

You gain one skill of your choice.

5th-Level Features

As a 5th-level summoner, you gain the following features.

5th-Level Circle Feature

Your circle grants you a feature as shown on the 5th-Level Summoner Circle Features table.

5th-Level Summoner Circle Features

Circle	Feature
Blight	Shaping, Soul Flense
Graves	Channel, Dread March
Spring	Flash Powder, Pixie Lift
Storms	Nature Watch, Split

Channel

You can spend 1 uninterrupted minute to perform a ritual and use your body as a host for a willing spirit of a creature who died in the area. While hosting the spirit, you have access to their memories of the 24 hours leading up to their death and any skills they knew in life. You can also magically change your appearance to look like them while they were alive.

You can attempt to stop channeling the spirit at any time. If the spirit is hostile to you or you've hosted them for at least 1 hour, you must make a **medium Presence test**. On success, the spirit leaves your body. On failure, you become fully possessed by a **haunt**; you have no access to your skills and you can't get above a tier 2 result on power rolls until you exorcise the haunt either by completing the Find a Cure downtime project in *Draw Steel: Heroes* or taking a respite with an exorcist.

After you stop channeling their spirit, you can't use this feature to channel the same creature again.

Dread March

You and your undead minions don't spend additional speed to move through difficult terrain. If one or more of your undead minions would die while using their move action, they can choose to not die until the end of your turn.

Flash Powder

Each ally that gains temporary Stamina from your Pixie Dust feature also gains one of the following effects until the end of their next turn (or for 10 minutes if used outside of combat):

- **Flight:** Their speed gains the Fly keyword.
- **Vanish:** They become invisible.
- **Water Weird:** As a free maneuver once per turn, they can teleport to a body of water within 5 squares of them.
- **Panacea:** They can end one condition affecting them or stand up.

Nature Watch

You can spend 1 uninterrupted minute each day to perform a ritual and summon a special elemental mote called a beacon to patrol the area. This mote telepathically communicates any hostile creatures, hazards, or traps within 20 squares of them to you no matter how far away you are. You know the number of nearby hazards and which direction they're in relative to where the beacon is, but not their exact position. You can have a number of beacons active equal to your level.

Pixie Lift

Your speed gains the Fly and Hover keywords. You lose the Hover keyword from this feature while you are dazed, dying, or you fly more than 1 square above the surface of the ground.

If your speed previously had the Fly keyword, you can now fly while sneaking an additional number of squares equal to your Reason.

Shaping

You can spend 1 uninterrupted minute to perform a ritual that causes one of your minions to fold their shape and disguise themself to look like a duplicate of you, including speaking basic Caelian, allowing them to (potentially) freely move through civilization while completing their tasks. You can have a number of minions disguised at the same time equal to your Reason score.

Split

Once during your turn, you can use a free maneuver to deal damage to one of your elemental minions equal to half their maximum Stamina in order to create one additional copy of that minion in an adjacent unoccupied space and add them to their squad, even if you're at your minion maximum. You can't use this feature if it would kill one or more of the minions in the squad.

Soul Flense

As a maneuver, you can command one or more of your demon minions to each deal damage equal to their free strike value to an adjacent ally. This damage can't be reduced. The ally then ends a condition affecting them and confers it to the demon that attacked them.

Additionally, whenever one of your demon minions Death Snaps, their target is P<WEAK affected by a condition the minion was suffering from. The potency increases by 1 on each subsequent Death Snap the target takes damage from in the same turn (maximum +2).

New Portfolio Minion

Your circle allows you to select new minions to add to your portfolio.

Demon Portfolio 7-Essence Minion

Choose one of the following minions.

Faded Blightling

This cherubin creature is bloated and warped by demonic energy. The lights from their myriad eyes have all but gone out, now resembling pustules across their body.

Faded Blightling — **Minion Support**
Abyssal, Demon — 7 essence for two minions

1L	5	17 | 17	0	7
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: — **Weakness:** Holy 1
Movement: Fly **Free Strike Damage Type:** Corruption

Might 0	**Agility** 0	**Reason** -1	**Intuition** +4	**Presence** +3

Blighted Strike 2d10 + R — **Signature Ability**
Magic, Ranged, Strike — Main action
Ranged 5 — One creature or object per minion

≤11 7 corruption damage; P<WEAK bleeding (EoT)
12-16 11 corruption damage; P<AVERAGE bleeding (EoT)
17+ 16 corruption damage; P<STRONG bleeding (EoT)

Effect: Instead of taking damage, you or an ally targeted by this ability impose a double bane on the next strike that targets them.

Wilted Wings
The blightling must land on the ground at the end of their turn or fall prone.

Soulsight
Each creature adjacent to the blightling can't be hidden from them.



Gorrre

The gorrre demons evoke features of rhino and orangutan while clad in heavy armor. They've been utilized as jail guards by devils, as few prisoners can ever hope to outrun a monster with unlimited endurance.

Gorrre
Abyssal, Demon

Minion Brute
7 essence for two minions

2	5	17 | 17	2	8
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: —

Weakness: Holy 1
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +4	**Agility** +3	**Reason** 0	**Intuition** -1	**Presence** 0

Gorrring Strike
The gorrre must charge before making a strike. The target is M<STRONG knocked prone if the gorrre moved through an enemy or object other than the target during the charge.

Devastating Charge
The gorrre ignores difficult terrain while charging and destroys unattended, size 1 objects in their path. Each enemy they move through during a charge takes 3 damage.

Soulsight
Each creature adjacent to the gorrre can't be hidden from them.



Vicisittante

It's difficult to identify the base nature of a vicisittante apart from an ever-changing mass of burning flesh. Any surface they touch immediately scars as the demon leaves parts of themselves behind.

Vicisittante
Abyssal, Demon

Minion Harrier
7 essence for two minions

2	10	17 | 17	0	7
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: —

Weakness: Holy 1
Free Strike Damage Type: Psychic

Might +3	**Agility** +4	**Reason** 0	**Intuition** 0	**Presence** -1

Cerebral Flay 2d10 + R
Melee, Psionic, Strike
Melee 1

Signature Ability
Main action
One creature or object per minion

≤11 7 psychic damage; P<WEAK weakened (save ends)
12-16 11 psychic damage; P<AVERAGE weakened (save ends)
17+ 16 psychic damage; P<STRONG weakened (save ends)

Effect: A target weakened by this ability is always considered flanked by the vicisittante regardless of position until the condition ends.

Soulsight
Each creature adjacent to the vicisittante can't be hidden from them.

Elemental Portfolio 7-Essence Minion

Choose one of the following minions.

Iron Reaver

Iron reavers are long, gnashing lines of centipede-like bladed legs. Their bodies endlessly shed metal shavings and hard sheets of iron as they move.

Iron Reaver **Minion Harrier**
Elemental (Earth, Fire, Void) 7 essence for three minions

1L	6	10 | 10 | 10	R	6
Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike

Immunity: Poison R
Movement: Burrow
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +3	Agility +4	Reason 0	Intuition 0	Presence -1

Decentralized Segments
The reaver has cover while adjacent to another reaver they were summoned with. Whenever they receive an effect that allows them to move or shift outside of their move action, they share the effect with each adjacent reaver they were summoned with.

Bladed Strike
The reaver's free strikes inflict M < WEAK bleeding (save ends). Each time the reaver inflicts bleeding on a creature, they can shift 2 and make an additional free strike on a new target.

Iron Barricade **1 Essence**
When the reaver is reduced to 0 Stamina, they create a line equal to 2 × their size centered on their space of iron shards on the ground until the end of the encounter. You or any ally has cover and damage immunity 2 while occupying an affected square.

Knight of Blood

These faceless suits of armor have visible rivers of deep red blood flowing throughout their being. Their blood has a powerful pull to it, causing any open wounds nearby to rip deeper and leak toward the knight.

Knight of Blood **Minion Controller**
Elemental (Earth, Fire, Rot, Water) 7 essence for two minions

1L	6	16 | 16	R	7
Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike

Immunity: Corruption R
Movement: —
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Corruption

Might +4	Agility +2	Reason 0	Intuition 0	Presence +3

Scarlet Death
The knight's melee strikes inflict P < STRONG bleeding (save ends). While bleeding this way, the target can't roll lower than a 3 on the die used to resolve bleeding damage.

Red River **2 Essence**
When the knight is reduced to 0 Stamina, they move up to their speed ignoring opportunity attacks. Each square that they exit during this movement pools with blood until the end of the encounter. Each affected square is considered difficult terrain for enemies and deals 3 corruption damage to an enemy when they first enter it on a turn. Whenever a bleeding enemy starts their turn within 10 squares of the blood pool, they are pulled 2 toward the nearest affected square, ignoring stability.

Light of the Sun

These elementals are blazing white avian-shaped beings that are nearly impossible to perceive directly. Between a light of the sun's talons is a massive glowing sword that can split the heaviest of defenses asunder.

Light of the Sun **Minion Support**
Elemental (Air, Green, Fire, Void) 7 essence for two minions

2	6	17 | 17	0	7
Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike

Immunity: Corruption R, fire R
Movement: Fly
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Fire

Might 0	Agility +2	Reason +4	Intuition 0	Presence +3

Solar Blade 2d10 + R **Signature Ability**
Magic, Melee, Strike Main action
Melee 1 One creature or object per minion

≤11 7 fire damage; I < WEAK dazed (EoT)
12–16 11 fire damage; I < AVERAGE dazed (EoT)
17+ 16 fire damage; I < STRONG dazed (save ends)

Effect: A target dazed by this ability has their stability reduced to 0 until the condition ends.

Radiant Field **2 Essence**
When the light is reduced to 0 Stamina, the area within 1 square of the light becomes wreathed in sentient flames until the end of the encounter. An enemy that enters this area or starts their turn there takes 3 fire damage and is slowed (EoT). You or any ally that enters this area or starts their turn there gains 5 temporary Stamina and their speed increases by 2 until the end of their turn.



Fey Portfolio 7-Essence Minion

Choose one of the following minions.

Nixie Corallia

Corallias are saltwater nixies with coarse, coral-like skin and curly hair with hooked ends. Their salty tears are used to hallow places of worship and ward off demons.

Nixie Corallia
Fey

Minion Support
7 essence for two minions

1T	6	17 | 17	0	7
Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike

Immunity: Lightning R
Movement: Swim

Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Lightning

Might -2	Agility +3	Reason +3	Intuition +4	Presence +1

★ **Water Weird**
Once per turn during their move action, each nixie under your control can teleport to a body of water within 6. The corallia can't teleport into water created by their own seafoam pool.

★ **Seafoam Pool**
The area within 2 squares of the corallia is filled with purifying saltwater that disables the effects of difficult terrain created by enemies. At the end of the corallia's turn, the corallia can scrub you or an ally in the affected area and end one condition.

★ **Minuscule**
The coralia has cover while occupying a larger creature's space.

Pixie Belladonix

The belladonix are found among the elite guard of fey monarchs and carry themselves like royalty. Their moth-like wings ooze with vibrant colors and are barbed; the poison within threatening to completely shift the reality of their victims.

Pixie Belladonix
Fey

Minion Artillery
7 essence for two minions

1T	6	16 | 16	0	8
Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike

Immunity: Poison R
Movement: Fly, hover

Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Poison

Might -2	Agility +2	Reason +4	Intuition 0	Presence +4

A Thorn, Woe to the Pricked 2d10 + R
Signature Ability
Magic, Ranged, Strike
Main action
Ranged 15
One creature or object per minion

≤11 8 poison damage; M<WEAK restrained (save ends)
12-16 12 poison damage; M<AVERAGE restrained (save ends)
17+ 17 poison damage; M<STRONG restrained (save ends)

Effect: A target restrained by this ability is trapped in a poison-fueled haze and considers each creature within 1 square of them to be an enemy until the condition ends.

★ **Minuscule**
The belladonix has cover while occupying a larger creature's space.



Sprite Olyender

These brawny sprites wear heavy beetle armor and have a halo hovering away from their backs where their wings used to be. The faster the halo spins, the more power the olyender generates, enabling them to stand toe to toe with giants.

Sprite Olyender
Fey

Minion Brute
7 essence for two minions

1T	6	17 | 17	R	8
Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike

Immunity: —
Movement: Fly

Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +4	Agility +3	Reason 0	Intuition +1	Presence +2

★ **Warrior's Toss**
The olyender's melee strikes inflict push 4. If the target is force moved into an object, they are M<AVERAGE knocked prone and can't stand (save ends).

★ **Use Their Might**
When targeting a creature with a grab or forced movement, the olyender's size is considered one larger than the target.

★ **Minuscule**
The olyender has cover while occupying a larger creature's space.

Undead Portfolio 7-Essence Minion

Choose one of the following minions.

False Vampire

A false vampire is a bestial, bipedal ghoul that draws life from liquified remains. In death, their hands curl into thick hooks, their bodies turn a putrid red-green as if wearing a dress suit, and their mouth twists and extends into a large feeding needle that can pierce steel.

False Vampire
Undead
Minion Brute
7 essence for two minions

1L	6	17 | 17	2	8
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption R, poison R
Movement: Climb
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Acid

Might +4	**Agility** +1	**Reason** +3	**Intuition** 0	**Presence** 0

Proboscis Strike
The false vampire's melee free strikes have a distance of 2 and inflict M<AVERAGE restrained (EoT). The false vampire can move the target while they are restrained this way. At the start of a restrained creature's turn, they take acid damage equal to your Reason.

Bloodthirsty
The false vampire has a speed of 10 while a creature is bleeding within 10.

Phantom of the Ripper

These phantoms puppet the remnants of their corporeal forms. Unlike other spirits, the ripper tears the reality around them and leaves behind distorted or uneven "bumps" in the air, which can affect stone, metal, and flesh.

Phantom of the Ripper
Undead
Minion Ambusher
7 essence for two minions

1M	6	17 | 17	1	8
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption R, poison R
Movement: Fly, hover
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might 0	**Agility** +4	**Reason** 0	**Intuition** 0	**Presence** +3

Plunge of the Knife 2d10 + R
Melee, Strike, Weapon
Melee 1
Signature Ability
Main action
One creature or object per minion

≤11 8 damage; A<WEAK slowed (save ends)
12-16 13 damage; A<AVERAGE slowed (save ends)
17+ 17 damage; A<STRONG slowed (save ends)

Effect: The phantom deals an additional 3 damage if they have an edge.

Ripping Phase
The phantom can move through other creatures and objects at normal speed. The first time in a round that the phantom passes through a creature, that creature takes 3 corruption damage and has a bane on their next strike. The phantom doesn't take damage from being force moved into objects.

Zombie Titan

Zombie titan is a catchall for undead giants, patchwork ogres and mournlings, or amalgamations of a graveyard's entire population. The titan lumbers and slumps across battlefields, wanting desperately to collapse and crash into the earth like a sea of flesh and bone.

Zombie Titan
Undead
Minion Defender
7 essence for one minion

4	4	40	R	7
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption R, poison R
Movement: —
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +4	**Agility** -3	**Reason** 0	**Intuition** +2	**Presence** +3

Big Stomp
The titan's melee free strikes M<STRONG knock the target prone.

Overwhelming Size
The titan can move through enemies at normal speed. If the titan ends their turn in a prone size 2 or smaller creature's space, the creature can't stand.

Flesh to Mountains
When the titan is reduced to 0 Stamina, their space becomes difficult terrain. If a creature was prone underneath the titan when the titan is killed, they take 10 damage and are restrained (save ends).

6th-Level Features

As a 6th-level summoner, you gain the following features.

Perk

You gain an interpersonal, lore, or supernatural perk of your choice. See **Perks** in *Draw Steel: Heroes* for more information.

Return to the Source

You can translate yourself and your allies into the space that your minions come from, as if summoning in reverse.

When you take a respite, you teleport to your circle's source manifold or point of origin, as shown on the Circle's Source Manifold table. You can bring along any allies to gather resources or research details about that location's denizens. You are seen as a native resident of the location, but your allies might be seen as intruders.

Circle's Source Manifold

Circle	Manifold or Point of Origin
Blight	Abyssal Waste
Graves	Necropolitan Ruins (located within the Abyssal Waste)
Spring	Arcadia
Storms	Quintessence

At the end of the respite, you and everyone you brought with you immediately teleports back into the same location from which you made the portal.

Minion Machinations

Your maximum number of followers increases by 2.

You can summon and recruit an artisan follower and a sage follower that share a keyword with a minion you can summon. These followers can be creatures from your portfolio or preexisting denizens of your circle's source manifold. See Follower Types under **Attract Followers** in *Draw Steel: Heroes* for information on constructing your followers' stats.

Kit Improvement

You can choose one additional ward from your Summoner's Kit.

Additionally, whenever you reduce an enemy to 0 Stamina with your Summoner Strike ability, you can use Call Forth as a free maneuver. Minions summoned this way are unable to act during this turn.

9-Essence Ability

You can summon the assistance of your future champion (see Portfolio Champion) and allow them to show off a brief display of their power. Select one of the following heroic abilities, each of which costs 9 essence to use.

A Champion's Cry (9 Essence)

Your champion unleashes a bellow that shakes you to your core.

Area, Champion, Magic — **Main action**
3 burst — Each enemy in the area

Power Roll + Reason:

- ≤11 — 2 psychic or sonic damage; I < WEAK frightened of you (save ends)
- 12–16 — 5 psychic or sonic damage; I < AVERAGE frightened of you and all allies (EoT)
- 17+ — 7 psychic or sonic damage; I < STRONG frightened of you and all allies (save ends)

Effect: You can use this ability as if in the space of one of your minions within your Summoner's Range.

Army's Idol (9 Essence)

Your champion's appearance has an enchanting impact on you and your allies.

Area, Champion, Magic — **Maneuver**
4 burst — Self and each ally in the area

Effect: You can use this ability as if in the space of one of your minions within your Summoner's Range.

Until the end of the encounter or you become dying, each target has a +2 bonus to saving throws.

Each target can immediately make each of their saving throws and stand up from prone.

The Champion Slams the Earth (9 Essence)

Your champion lays their fury upon those unfortunate enough to be in their wake.

Area, Champion, Magic, Weapon — **Main action**
4 cube within 1 — Each enemy and object in the area

Power Roll + Reason:

- ≤11 — 5 damage; M < WEAK prone and can't stand (save ends)
- 12–16 — 8 damage; M < AVERAGE prone and can't stand (save ends)
- 17+ — 11 damage; M < STRONG prone and can't stand (save ends)

Effect: You can use this ability as if in the space of one of your minions within your Summoner's Range.
Special: You can change the damage type to be a type that your champion deals on their stat block (see Portfolio Champion).

Their Pall Shrouds All (9 Essence)

Your champion fills the area with a thick haze hiding friend from foe.

Area, Champion, Magic — **Maneuver**
4 burst — Each enemy in the area

Effect: You can use this ability as if in the space of one of your minions within your Summoner's Range.

Each target is R < AVERAGE weakened (save ends).

Until the end of the encounter, whenever a target gets a tier 1 result on a strike, they deal half damage. If a target was striking a creature adjacent to one of their allies, they target their ally instead.

7th-Level Features

As a 7th-level summoner, you gain the following features.

Characteristic Increase

All of your characteristics increase by 1, to a maximum score of 4.

Minion Improvement

At the start of each of your turns during combat, you can summon one additional signature minion at no cost into an unoccupied space within your Summoner's Range (no action required).

Additionally, you can increase each of your minions' Stamina as shown on the 7th-Level Minion Stamina Increase table. Additionally, each minion that receives a Stamina boost can treat their characteristics as one higher for the purposes of resisting potencies (to a maximum value of 4).

These benefits are not reflected in the stat blocks of new minions you acquire.

7th-Level Minion Stamina Increase

Minion	Stamina Increase
Signature Minion	Stamina +1 (to a total of +2)
3-Essence Minion	Stamina +3 (to a total of +6)
5-Essence Minion	Stamina +2 (to a total of +4)
7-Essence Minion	Stamina +5

Font of Creation

When you gain essence at the start of each of your turns during combat, you gain 3 essence instead of 2.

Their Life for Mine

If you or an ally within your Summoner's Range would die from an effect that isn't age related, you sacrifice all your active minions (minimum 1) and spend all your essence (minimum 1) as a free triggered action to bring the target back to life, reconstructing the damaged parts of their body with summoned material related to your portfolio. The target comes back with 0 Stamina plus 1 Stamina for each minion and essence used in the effect. You must have at least one fragment of the creature's remains, and the creature's soul must be willing to return to life for the effect to work.

You can't use this feature again until you gain a new level, or until you spend 3 eidos to use it (see Eidos).

Skill

You gain one skill of your choice.

8th-Level Features

As an 8th-level summoner, you gain the following features.

Perk

You gain any one perk of your choice. See **Perks** in *Draw Steel: Heroes* for more information.

8th-Level Circle Feature

Your circle grants you a feature as shown on the 8th-Level Summoner Circle Features table.

8th-Level Summoner Circle Features

Circle	Feature
Blight	Abyssal Evolution
Graves	Kill the Pain
Spring	Celestial Grace
Storms	Control the Elements

Abyssal Evolution

At the start of each of your turns, you can transform up to two of your demon minions within your Summoner's Range. A demon can transform into a different demon minion within your Summoner's Range, maintaining their current Stamina. Starting from round 2, a demon can transform any demon minion you can call forth for half the essence cost, as if you summoned the new minion into the demon's space.

The minions must be reassigned to a new squad if their new name differs from the other squad members.

Celestial Grace

Your number of Recoveries further increases by 2.

Additionally, the area affected by your Pixie Dust feature and any of your fey minions' traits that affect adjacent creatures and/or the area within 1 or more squares of them increase that distance by 1 square.

Control the Elements

Whenever you use Call Forth, you can spend essence to change the size of one elemental minion you summon as shown on the following table.

Control the Elements

Essence Cost	Size Change
1	The minion becomes size 2.
3	The minion becomes size 3.
5	The minion becomes size 4.

Kill the Pain

You aren't affected by excess damage after all minions in a squad are dead.

Additionally, you and each of your undead minions ignore damage rolled as a d3 or a d6 and damage from environmental effects while you are not winded.

Portfolio Champion

Your circle now allows you to add a champion to your portfolio. Champions follow the same rules as your other minions, with the following exceptions:

- You can only summon and command one instance of your champion.
- Your champion is in their own squad that does not count toward your maximum number of squads.
- Your champion can regain Stamina and gain temporary Stamina.
- Your champion uses your Recoveries to regain Stamina.
- Your champion can take the Heal and Defend Actions.
- Your champion uses the normal rules for maneuvers.
- You have an edge whenever you use an ability with the Champion keyword from your Champion's space.
- Your champion refuses to be referred to as a minion.

After summoning a champion, you can't summon them again until you earn a Victory.

Your champion gains additional features at 10th level. This includes a special Champion Action ability that costs eidos to use (see Eidos). This ability can be activated once per encounter at the end of any other creature's turn.



Demon Portfolio Champion

Your champion is an Aspect of a demon lord. They have borne witness to your exploits and struck a deal with you: Allow their children to feed and you can call forth a modicum of their power. Morality is none of their concern, but certainly a hero is enough of an arbiter of whose souls deserve to be fed to demons, right?

The demon lord's Aspect enjoys bringing enemies in close with their appendages or flinging victims and throwing them to the gnashing horde. They're willing to put your connection to this world at risk if it means taking one more bite.

Demon Lord's Aspect **Champion**
Abyssal, Demon — 9 essence for one champion

2	5	SPECIAL	2	9
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Stamina: Your maximum Stamina
Immunity: Corruption 5
Movement: Teleport
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Corruption

Might +2 **A**gility +5 **R**eason +5 **I**ntuition +2 **P**resence +2

Grasping Appendages 2d10 + 5 — **Signature Ability**
Melee, Strike, Weapon — Main action
Melee 5 — Two creatures or objects

≤11 9 corruption damage; pull 2
12-16 12 corruption damage; pull 4
17+ 14 corruption damage; pull 5

Effect: A target pulled adjacent to the Aspect is grabbed.

Warping Strike
The Aspect's free strikes teleport the target 5 squares.

Champion's Ire
If the Aspect only targets one creature or object with a strike, they deal additional damage to the target equal to your Reason.

I Like Your Taste
— — Free triggered action
Self — Self

Trigger: The Aspect takes damage from an enemy.
Effect: The Aspect has a double edge on their next power roll. They can choose to give this benefit to an ally within your Summoner's Range instead.

Frenzy
When the Aspect is reduced to 0 Stamina, they make a free strike against each adjacent enemy before dying.

Level 10 Champion Advancement Feature

Size Increase
The Aspect is now size 3.

Reality Flense — **1 Eidos**
— — Champion Action
20 burst — Self and each non-minion ally in the area

Effect: Each target teleports up to their speed and makes a free strike. If a target has a Save Ends condition, they can inflict the condition onto a creature with their strike and end the condition on themself.

Elemental Portfolio Champion

Your champion is a Portent of a dragon yet to manifest. Through defending the innocent, you have made yourself and your elementals a close neighbor to the malice that threatens them. The dragon desires you bring their creation about and lends you strength to see your justice through.

As a harbinger of ruin, the dragon's Portent has incredibly potent impact and control of the environment. Their final shape has yet to be determined; use this to your advantage and call upon the affinity that will end conflict the quickest.



Dragon's Portent

Dragon, Elemental

Champion
9 essence for one champion

2	6	SPECIAL	4	9
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Stamina: Your maximum Stamina
Immunity: Affinity 5
Movement: Fly

Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Affinity

Might +2 **A**gility +2 **R**eason +5 **I**ntuition +5 **P**resence +2

Affinity
The Portent selects an affinity for one of the following damage types when they are summoned: acid, cold, corruption, fire, lightning, or poison. This type determines the Portent's affinity immunity and the damage type of their abilities.

Elemental Tail Swing 2d10 + 5
Charge, Melee, Strike, Weapon
Melee 2

Signature Ability
Main action
Two creatures or objects

≤11 9 affinity damage; push 2
12-16 12 affinity damage; push 4
17+ 14 affinity damage; push 6

Sealing Strike
The Portent's free strikes inflict M<STRONG slowed (save ends). While slowed this way, the target takes 1d6 affinity damage at the start of each of their turns.

Champion's Ire
If the Portent only targets one creature or object with a strike, they deal additional damage to the target equal to your Reason.

Searing Wyrmscale
Whenever an adjacent creature deals damage to the Portent, they take 4 affinity damage.

Dragon Heart
Once per turn, the Portent can take 10 damage to allow you or an ally within your Summoner's Range to gain 1 heroic resource. This damage can't be reduced in any way.

Level 10 Champion Advancement Feature

Size Increase
The Portent is now size 3.

A Breath Felt in a Hurricane
Area, Magic, Ranged
4 cube within 10

1 Eidos
Champion Action
Each enemy and object in the area

Effect: 9 affinity damage. The damage ignores immunity. The affected area becomes difficult terrain. An enemy has affinity weakness 5 while occupying an affected square.

Fey Portfolio Champion

Your champion is an Attendant of a celestial. Whenever you call on their assistance, you must formally welcome and introduce them to the occasion. You can't be certain if this is truly the blessing of a celestial you've previously allied yourself with, or if you've received someone else's power—neither circumstance puts you in any less danger.

The celestial Attendant wants to swarm the map with pixies while limiting their foes' ability to do anything about it. A single neurotoxic strike is all it takes to move everyone into position.

Celestial Attendant

Fey

Champion
9 essence for one champion

2	7	SPECIAL	0	9
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Stamina: Your maximum Stamina
Immunity: Damage 2
Movement: Fly, hover

Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Poison

Might +2 **A**gility +2 **R**eason +5 **I**ntuition +2 **P**resence +5

Pixie Swarm 2d10 + 5
Magic, Ranged, Strike
Ranged 10

Signature Ability
Main action
Two creatures or objects

≤11 9 damage; slide 3
12–16 12 damage; slide 5
17+ 14 damage; slide 6

Effect: An ally targeted by this ability can, instead, spend Recovery and shift the slide amount.

Neurotoxic Strike
A creature that takes damage from the Attendant's free strike is I<AVERAGE unable to establish line of effect beyond 3 squares (EoT).

Champion's Ire
If the Attendant only targets one creature or object with a strike, they deal additional damage to the target equal to your Reason.

Celestial Bell
—
Self

Free triggered action
Self

Trigger: The Attendant takes damage from an enemy.
Effect: The Attendant rings a bell, and you summon a signature minion into an unoccupied space adjacent to the Attendant.

Pixie Bouquet
The Attendant starts their turn with temporary Stamina equal to 2 × the number of fey minions within 1 square of them. This temporary Stamina lasts until the start of their next turn.

Level 10 Champion Advancement Feature

Size Increase
The Attendant is now size 3.

A Shower of Dust
—
20 burst

1 Eidos
Champion Action
Self and each non-minion ally in the area

Effect: Each target gains 20 temporary Stamina and receives the benefits of one of your Flash Powder effects until the end of their next turn.



Undead Portfolio Champion

Your champion is an Avatar of death. The number of creatures you and your army have laid to rest now hangs above your head and threatens to crush your skull at any moment. You were unable to gain the power of the ultimate force of nature without a memento mori to keep you humble.

The Avatar of death weighs down their foes with conditions so their army can take care of the rest. If an enemy can't handle it, well then maybe they should just die.

Avatar of Death

Undead

Champion
9 essence for one champion

2	6	SPECIAL	3	9
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Stamina: Your maximum Stamina
Immunity: Corruption 5, poison 5
Movement: Fly

Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Holy

Might +5 **A**gility +2 **R**eason +5 **I**ntuition +2 **P**resence +2

Culling Scythe 2d10 + 5
Melee, Strike, Weapon
Melee 2

Signature Ability
Main action
Two creatures or objects

≤11 9 corruption damage; M < WEAK bleeding (save ends)
12–16 12 corruption damage; M < AVERAGE bleeding (save ends)
17+ 14 corruption damage; M < STRONG bleeding (save ends)

Effect: If the target is a creature that isn't a leader or a solo and they are still bleeding at the end of the encounter, they instantly die.

Revelation Strike
The Avatar's melee free strikes P < WEAK instantly reduce a winded non-leader or solo creature to 0 Stamina, including targets winded by the strike.

Champion's Ire
If the Avatar only targets one creature or object with a strike, they deal additional damage to the target equal to your Reason.

Dust and Rot
Area
1 burst

Free triggered action
Each enemy in the burst

Trigger: The Avatar takes damage.
Effect: M < AVERAGE weakened (EoT).

Drifting Spirit
The Avatar is unaffected by difficult terrain and damage from forced movement.

Level 10 Champion Advancement Feature

Size Increase
The Avatar is now size 3.

Gravemaker
Area, Magic, Ranged
5 × 3 line within 1

1 Eidos
Champion Action
Each enemy and object in the line

Effect: 9 holy damage. Each target is vertically pulled a number of squares equal to their size straight down, ignoring stability. If the target would be force moved into the ground, they are buried beneath the ground instead.



9th-Level Features

As a 9th-level summoner, you gain the following features.

Kit Improvement

You've conjured your kit into its ultimate form. You have the following benefits:

- The potency of your Summoner Strike ability increases to R<STRONG.
- You can choose one additional ward from your Summoner's Kit.
- You have a double edge on tests made to dissuade or scare enemy minions or lackeys.
- Your clothing and equipment become adorned with distinct and elaborate regalia to make you stand out from your army, like massive rib cage pauldrons, a tooth crested helmet, or a billowing mantle of fire.

Steward of Two Worlds

You and your allies are now welcome in your circle's source manifold. Negotiations with native denizens of your circle's source manifold have their patience increased by 2.

11-Essence Ability

Choose one heroic ability from the following options, each of which costs 11 essence to use.

10,000 Minions (11 Essence)

The battle is now a war. Your entire army storms the field.

Magic — **Main action**
Special — Special

Effect: Until the end of the encounter or you are dying, each square on the ground is considered teeming with minions. An enemy that ends their turn in an affected square takes 5 damage. This damage can't be reduced.

Additionally, you can use Minion Bridge treating each affected square as an eligible minion (up to a maximum of 10 additional squares).

Bodyguard Tactics (11 Essence)

You surround your allies with a nigh-endless supply of summons that stand in the way of all impacts.

Area, Magic — **Main action**
5 burst — Self and each non-minion ally in the area

Effect: Until the end of the encounter or you are dying, each target has damage immunity 5 and can use a free triggered action once per turn whenever they are force moved to reduce the distance by half.

I Abjure Thee (11 Essence)

Cast those not affixed to this manifold into the void of a minion's existence.

Area, Magic — **Main action**
3 burst — Special

Effect: Each enemy minion in the area is permanently removed from the encounter map. Up to three non-leader or non-solo enemies in the area are removed from the encounter for 1 round.

A leader or a solo enemy in the area that has R, I, or P<AVERAGE is weakened and slowed (save ends) as they are partially removed from the manifold. You can increase the potency by 1 for each of your minions adjacent to the target you choose to sacrifice as a part of using this ability.

The Champion's Wrath (11 Essence)

Your champion appears and goes into a rampage, clearing the way for your minions to march forth.

Area, Champion, Magic, Weapon — **Main action**
4 burst — Each enemy in the area

Power Roll + Reason:

≤11 6 damage; push 4 M<WEAK push is vertical
12–16 10 damage; push 5 M<AVERAGE push is vertical
17+ 14 damage; push 6 M<STRONG push is vertical

Effect: You can use this ability as if in the space of one of your minions within your Summoner's Range.

You can change the damage type to be a type that your champion deals on their stat block (see Portfolio Champion). For each enemy reduced to 0 Stamina by this ability, an ally within distance can move up to their speed.



10th-Level Features

As a 10th-level summoner, you gain the following features.

Characteristic Increase

Your Reason score becomes 5. Additionally, you can increase one of your characteristic scores by 1, to a maximum score of 5.

Minion Improvement

You now start encounters and round-tracked situations by summoning up to two additional minions for every two Victories you have (in addition to the two you normally summon).

Each of your minions' Stamina improves as shown on the 10th-Level Minion Stamina Increase table. Additionally, each minion that receives a Stamina boost can treat their characteristics as one higher for the purposes of resisting potencies (to a maximum value of 5).

10th-Level Minion Stamina Increase

Minion	Stamina Increase
Signature Minion	Stamina +1 (to a total of +3)
3-Essence Minion	Stamina +3 (to a total of +9)
5-Essence Minion	Stamina +2 (to a total of +6)
7-Essence Minion	Stamina +5 (to a total of +10)

Eidos

You gain an epic resource called eidos. When you take a respite, you gain eidos equal to the XP you gain. You can spend eidos as if it were essence on minions and abilities you have. When you do, you summon up to two bonus signature minions into unoccupied spaces within your Summoner's Range.

You and your champion also have access to abilities that can be used by spending eidos (see Their Life for Mine and Portfolio Champion).

Eidos remains until you spend it.

No Matter the Cost

Whenever you sacrifice minions, you now reduce the cost of a heroic ability or minion by the same amount (to a minimum of 1) instead of only reducing the cost by 1.

Among Our Ranks

As a respite activity, you summon a willing and not-restrained NPC or player ally to join your party, regardless of distance or manifold. The target stays until the start of your next respite or until they are killed, in which they are immediately dismissed to the place from which they were summoned. You can't have more than one character summoned in this way.

Perk

You gain an intrigue, interpersonal, or supernatural perk of your choice. See **Perks** in *Draw Steel: Heroes* for more information.

Skill

You gain one skill of your choice.

REWARDS

Unless otherwise stated, the following treasures and titles can be wielded by a summoner or any hero who comes upon one.

New Trinkets

The following new trinkets are available to add to your game.

1st-Echelon Trinket

The following 1st-echelon trinket was designed for summoners but can be used by any class.

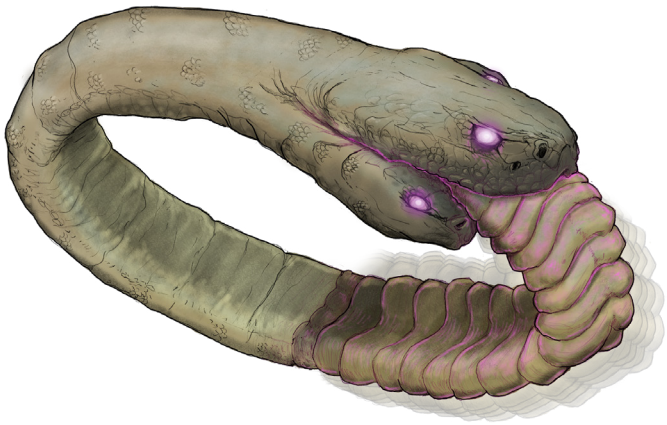
Snakerattle Bangle

This loose-fitting, scaley bangle shifts and slithers while worn. It emits a bone-chilling rattle each time it hits its user's wrist.

Keywords: Arms, Magic
Item Prerequisite: The tail of a size 3 or larger rattlesnake
Project Source: Texts or lore in Anjali
Project Roll Characteristic: Reason or Intuition
Project Goal: 150

Effect: While wearing this bangle, your melee free strikes inflict I < AVERAGE frightened (EoT). The potency increases by 1 if you have an edge on the power roll.

Special: If you are a summoner, you regain the use of your standard melee free strike while wearing this bangle.



2nd-Echelon Trinkets

The following 2nd-echelon trinkets were designed for summoners but can be used by any class.

Abyssal Map Ink

The puddle of living ink snarls and snaps while it feeds on parchment and smooth surfaces. It spreads itself across its meal until it resembles a flat, top-down view of its immediate surroundings, wriggling and readjusting itself wherever it goes.

Keywords: Magic
Item Prerequisite: A vial of pitling spit, and a jar of human blood
Project Source: Texts or lore in Tholl
Project Roll Characteristic: Reason or Intuition
Project Goal: 300

Effect: While the ink is spread on a smooth surface or a piece of parchment paper, it turns into a size 1T or 1S map. This map grants you a double edge on tests you make using the Navigate skill. If you have the map active before the start of an encounter, you can move up to three allies (including yourself) up to 3 squares away from the starting area.

Grasp of the Chained Hand

A gauntlet of loose chains rattles, shackled to each of the user's fingers. They clatter whenever magic surges through them.

Keywords: Arms, Magic
Item Prerequisite: Blood-soaked chains that restrained a demon for at least 30 days
Project Source: Texts or lore in the Tholl
Project Roll Characteristic: Reason or Presence
Project Goal: 300

Effect: While wearing this gauntlet, your ranged free strikes have the Magic keyword and if the target has P < AVERAGE, they are magically chained to you until the end of their next turn. While chained, the target can't move farther away from you, and you can use a maneuver to either vertically pull the target up to 3 squares or shift yourself up to 3 squares through the air toward the target.

Special: If you are a summoner, you regain the use of your standard ranged free strike while wearing this gauntlet.

Thunder Chariot

A porcelain cart with golden filigree and wheels that crackle with electricity.

Keywords: Magic
Item Prerequisite: Twenty lightning bolts frozen in time
Project Source: Texts or lore in the First Language
Project Roll Characteristic: Reason or Intuition
Project Goal: 300

Effect: The thunder chariot can be used as a size 2 mount. Its speed is equal to its rider's speed + 3.

While riding in the thunder chariot, you have lightning immunity 5. An ally can use their maneuver while adjacent to you to move up to their speed, pulling you along.

3rd-Echelon Trinkets

The following 3rd-echelon trinkets were designed for summoners but can be used by any class.

Cross of the Scorned Puppeteer

This shiny black marionette cross reveals a masked figure standing in its reflection where its wielder should be.

Keywords: Magic, Psionic
Item Prerequisite: A spool of silk, a plank of stage wood, and the soul of a famous performer
Project Source: A record of a soulbinder ritual in Anjali
Project Roll Characteristic: Reason or Intuition
Project Goal: 450

Effect: While holding the cross, it emits faint strings made of light that you can control with your mind.

Whenever an enemy minion is reduced to 0 Stamina within 5 squares of you, you can use a free triggered action to attach a string of light to their corpse and command an illusory double of them until the end of the encounter. The minion is organized into the cross's squad of minions with the same name under your command (up to a maximum of six minions). On each of your turns, you can direct the squad to move and use a main action while they're within 5 squares of you.

You can also pull the strings of your allies to keep them out of harm's way. Whenever an ally takes damage within 5 squares of you, you can use a triggered action to vertically pull them 5 squares (ignoring stability) and halve the damage.

Special: If you are a summoner holding the cross, you can organize the minions gained with the cross into one of your class's squads instead.

Crystallized Essence

A storm rages at the center of this color-shifting shard of rock.

Keywords: Magic
Item Prerequisite: The remains of an elemental
Project Source: Records in Rhorvic
Special: The treasure must be crafted within a cave in Quintessence
Project Roll Characteristic: Reason or Intuition
Project Goal: 450

Effect: While holding crystallized essence, the distance of your ranged magic abilities increases by 5. Any creatures you create or summon using magic have their Stamina increased by one-third of their Stamina maximum.

Additionally, you can shatter and destroy the crystallized essence as a maneuver to immediately give yourself 5 essence.

Warbanner of Pride

A large banner billows from this tall flagpole. Its heraldry depicts a three-headed lion covered in wounds but still standing.

Keywords: Magic
Item Prerequisite: A king's cape and a solid gold flagpole
Project Source: Texts or lore in Caelian
Project Roll Characteristic: Reason or Intuition
Project Goal: 450

Effect: While holding the banner, you have a +1 bonus to saving throws and resisting potencies.

At the end of each of your turns, each ally within 10 squares of you can make a saving throw against one effect they are suffering that is ended by a saving throw.

4th-Echelon Trinkets

The following 4th-echelon trinkets were designed for summoners but can be used by any class.

Hagbasket

This throne woven from wood, hair, and metal floats several feet above the ground. The gentle humming it makes while it soars sounds reminiscent of a hag's cackle.

Keywords: Magic
Item Prerequisite: A mundane broom, a hag's hut, and a hag's kiss
Project Source: Texts or lore in Khelt
Project Roll Characteristic: Reason or Intuition
Project Goal: 600

Effect: The hagbasket can be used as a size 2 mount. Its speed is equal to its rider's speed, and it can fly and hover.

While riding in the hagbasket, power rolls made against you have a double edge. However, you can use a free triggered action when a power roll made against you gets a tier 3 result to halve the damage.

Special: If you are a summoner riding in the hagbasket, you can use a maneuver to enable a willing ally within your Summoner's Range to use Minion Bridge using your minions.

Warbanner of Wrath

A large banner billows from this tall flagpole. Its heraldry depicts a dragon breathing fire with outstretched wings covered in holes and tears.

Keywords: Magic
Item Prerequisite: A king's deathbed veil and a solid brass flagpole
Project Source: Texts or lore in Caelian
Project Roll Characteristic: Reason or Intuition
Project Goal: 600

Effect: You can choose to regain 1 Recovery at the end of every combat encounter while holding the banner.

Once per turn when you or an ally within 10 squares of you makes a melee strike, the strike can deal extra damage based on the number of Recoveries the striker has left. The strike deals +1 damage if the striker has more than half their Recoveries remaining, +2 damage if the striker has half or fewer but still at least one of their Recoveries remaining, and +5 damage if the striker has no Recoveries.

New Leveled Treasures

The following new leveled treasures are available to add to your game.

Leveled Implement Treasures

The following implements were designed for summoners but can be used by any class.

33 Field Commanders Baton

This long, ornate rod with a silver bulb head is braided with 33 green cords. A new cord starts to grow while you wield the baton.

Keywords: Implement, Magic
Item Prerequisite: A silver ingot and a written strategy from 33 warleaders
Project Source: Texts or lore in Caelian
Project Roll Characteristic: Reason, Intuition, or Presence
Project Goal: 450

Special: If you are a tactician, you can wield this implement as if it had the Light Weapon keyword. Replace any reference to magic or psionic abilities with weapon abilities.

1st Level: While you wield this baton, you are imbued with the experience of the commanders who wielded it before you. Your magic or psionic abilities that deal rolled damage gain a +1 damage bonus. On your turn, whenever you or an ally deal damage to a creature within 5 squares of you, you can immediately use your maneuver to slide the creature up to 2 squares.

5th Level: The baton's damage bonus increases to +2. When you slide a creature using this ability and they end this slide adjacent to one of your allies, that ally can use the Grab or Knockback maneuver against the creature as a free triggered action.

9th Level: The baton's damage bonus increases to +3. On your turn, whenever you or an ally deal damage to a creature within 10 squares of you, you can immediately use your maneuver to slide the creature up to 3 squares, ignoring stability.

Rex Scepter

The rod resembles a simple tree branch. It grows and braids itself into an ornate scepter in the heat of battle.

Keywords: Implement, Magic
Item Prerequisite: A tree branch and fealty from three hundred or more sworn followers
Project Source: Texts or lore in Zaliac
Project Roll Characteristic: Might, Reason, or Presence
Project Goal: 450

1st Level: While you wield this scepter, your Renown is increased by 1. Additionally, you can use a main action once per turn targeting a willing ally or two minions you control within 5 squares of you to make a free strike on a target within the same distance of you as a free triggered action.

5th Level: The scepter's bonus to Renown increases to +2. Additionally, whenever a creature you command using the scepter makes a free strike, they gain 1 surge that can be used immediately.

9th Level: The scepter's bonus to Renown increases to +4. Additionally, the scepter's main action can now be used as a maneuver.

Sanctuary Horn

This spiral hunting horn is embellished with branching veins of copper across the body. The metal glows red hot as the horn is blown.

Keywords: Implement, Magic
Item Prerequisite: The spiral shell of a fallen armory snail and whirlwinds captured from Quintessence
Project Source: Texts or lore in Kalliak
Project Roll Characteristic: Might, Reason, or Intuition
Project Goal: 450

1st Level: While you wield the horn, your magic and psionic strikes deal sonic damage instead of their usual damage. Additionally, you can use a maneuver once per turn to blow the horn, allowing one ally or up to two minions you control within 5 squares of you to be recalled, instantly teleporting them into unoccupied spaces adjacent to you.

5th Level: While you wield the horn, the area of your cube, burst, and aura magic or psionic abilities increases by 1. Additionally, whenever a creature is teleported by this horn, they can choose to either spend a Recovery or gain a surge.

9th Level: The horn's area bonus increases to 2. After you blow the horn as a maneuver, you can teleport yourself, another ally, or up to two other minions you control within 5 squares of you into the space left behind by a recalled target, provided they fit into the space.

Wand of the Unheard Orchestra

This conductor's baton has an unassuming and inornate steel body. It increases in length when it's swung and flashes a bright light when wanded at a regular interval.

Keywords: Implement, Magic
Item Prerequisite: An iron ingot and a singing tree's wood found in Arcadia
Project Source: Texts or lore in Khelt
Project Roll Characteristic: Agility, Reason, or Intuition
Project Goal: 450

1st Level: While you wield this wand, your magic or psionic abilities have their distance increased by 3. Additionally, you can use a maneuver once per turn targeting yourself or a willing ally within 5 squares of you to use a move action as a free triggered action.

5th Level: The wand's distance bonus increases to +5. Additionally, you and any minions you control have their speed increased by 2. Whenever you or any minions you control take the Disengage move action, they can shift 2 additional squares as part of that move action.

9th Level: The wand's distance bonus increases to +8. Additionally, the wand's maneuver can now be used as a free maneuver once during your turn, targeting yourself or an ally within 10 squares of you to use a move action as a free triggered action.

New Titles

The following titles are available to add to your game.

1st-Echelon Title

The following title was designed for summoners but is available for any hero.

Safeguarded

They risk their lives for me because I risk my life for theirs. This fight belongs to all of us!

Prerequisite: You earn a noble rank or earn the favor of a knight's guild.

Effect: You start combat encounters with a squad of three minions from the specific monster band or people you earned this title from. The squad takes their turn as a part of your turn. On the squad's turn, they can take a move action and either a main action or a maneuver.

Special: If two or more heroes in the party have this title from the same source, the party starts combat encounters with a squad of six minions instead. At the start of each round of combat, the heroes decide who controls the squad as a part of their turn.

2nd-Echelon Titles

The following titles were designed for summoners but are available for any hero.

Sigilwright

Let's find out who's on the other side of the circle.

Prerequisite: You complete a ritual to summon a non-minion entity using a summoning circle you drew.

Effect: Choose one of the following benefits:

Quick Gate: As a maneuver, you can etch an arcane circle in an adjacent square on the ground. Until the end of the encounter, you can use magic abilities and treat your Summoner's Range as if you were in that space. Each time you etch an arcane circle, your last circle fades and becomes inactive.

Ritual Circle: As a respite activity, you can draw a minor summoning circle to temporarily call forth a creature you've contacted previously, regardless of manifold. If the creature is willing and able to answer your call, they appear to you for the remainder of the respite. You can ask the creature for information or a service in exchange for ending the respite with two fewer Recoveries or a demand of their choosing. If the creature doesn't appear, you can choose to take a different respite activity.

Sigil Eye: You have an edge on tests made to identify summoning circles and who or where they're connected to. You also have an edge on strikes made against creatures not native to the manifold in which you're currently located.

Summoner Successor

When their leader fell, they started listening to me for some reason.

Prerequisite: You can't use the Call Forth ability, and you defeat a leader or solo creature with a Summon or Call Forth ability, such as a high elf ordinator.

Effect: Choose a signature minion from a summoner's portfolio that shares a keyword with one of the creatures the summoner could summon. You can summon three of that minion into a single squad (up to a maximum of four creatures) at the start of each of your turns in combat. The distance you can command them is equal to your ranged free strike distance. You also gain the Strike for Me triggered ability, which now has the Psionic keyword and loses the Magic keyword.

Additionally, you can summon up to two of your signature minion while outside of combat to do simple tasks.

3rd-Echelon Title

The following title was designed for summoners but is available for any hero.

Ringleader

Don't worry. I've got a guy.

Prerequisite: You complete three downtime projects during the same respite with the help of followers or minions.

Effect: You no longer need line of effect to give commands to any minions you can summon. Additionally, choose one of the following benefits:

For the Boss: Your followers gain a +3 bonus to project rolls that they make.
Networker: Your maximum follower count increases by 1.
Stringpuller: While occupying a civilized area (such as a village, town, district, or city), you always have access to a follower native to the location. If the area is otherwise hostile to you, this follower is a spy in hiding who has any project points they earn halved.

4th-Echelon Titles

The following titles are available for summoners.

Delegator

They're all yours, buddy.

Prerequisite: You are a summoner, and you strike a deal with your portfolio's champion.

Effect: At the start of a combat encounter, you can choose to translate yourself into your circle's source manifold while your champion fights and summons monsters in your place. The champion uses your Stamina, Recoveries, abilities, and features (except for your Summoner Strikes and Summoner's Kit). You can dismiss the champion and summon yourself back into the place you left at the end of an encounter.

If your champion would die while taking your place, you lose access to your Return to the Source feature and can only summon signature minions until you revive your champion as a respite activity.

High Summoner of the Circle

As I was taught, so I pass on to you.

Prerequisite: You are a summoner, and you teach someone how to call forth two or more minions from your portfolio.

Effect: You are considered a master that can be learned from using the Learn from a Master downtime project in *Draw Steel: Heroes*. Anyone that makes a project roll using you as the source gains a bonus to their roll equal to your Reason. Additionally, choose one of the following benefits:

Essence Mastery: Your minions cost one fewer essence to summon (minimum cost of 1 essence).
Expanded Domain: Your Summoner's Range increases by 5. You can use your minions' senses as your own as long as they're on the same manifold as you.
Signature Summoner: Select a 3-Essence minion you can call forth. At the start of each of your turns in combat, you summon the set number of minions listed on the stat block in place of your signature minions at no cost.



OTHER SUMMONERS

Retainer Summoner

Whenever the following retainer would gain a new advancement ability, the player of their mentor can either choose one of the available retainer abilities for that level or select a role advancement ability that matches their role and level.

Devil Detective

Devil, Infernal

Level 1 Controller Retainer

1M	5	21	0	2
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Fire 2
Movement: —
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might -1 **A**gility 0 **R**eason +2 **I**ntuition +2 **P**resence 0

Demon Summoner
The detective can command up to two squads of minions with a maximum of 4 minions per squad. They can only have one squad of signature minions active at any time.
At the start of each of the detective's turns, up to three **razors** appear in unoccupied spaces within 5 squares of the detective. On each of the detective's turns, they direct the squad of razors to move and use a main action.

Diabolic Probe 2d10 + highest characteristic — **Signature Ability**
Magic, Ranged, Strike — Main action
Ranged 10 — One creature or object

≤11 1 damage
12-16 3 damage
17+ 5 damage; **R <STRONG** slowed (save ends)

Effect: The target takes an additional 1 damage for each demon adjacent to them.

True Name
If a creature within 10 squares speaks the detective's true name, the detective loses their damage immunities and can't summon any **razors** until the end of the encounter.

Razor
Abyssal, Demon

Signature Minion Harrier

Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike
1M	6	2	0	1

Immunity: —
Movement: —
Weakness: Holy 1
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might	Agility	Reason	Intuition	Presence
0	+2	-1	-1	-1

★ **Teeth!**
Once per turn, whenever an adjacent enemy grabs the razor or uses a melee ability against them, that enemy takes 1 damage for each razor adjacent to them.

★ **Soulsight**
Each creature adjacent to the razor can't be hidden from them.

Level 4 Retainer Advancement Ability

Soul Sleuth 2d10 + highest characteristic
Area, Magic
4 cube within 5
Encounter
Main action
Each enemy or object in the area

Special: The detective can instantly kill one or more of their minions to give themself a double edge on the power roll.

≤11 2 damage; A<WEAK bleeding (save ends)
12-16 4 damage; A<AVERAGE bleeding (save ends)
17+ 5 damage; A<STRONG bleeding (save ends)

Effect: Any enemy that was hiding in the area is revealed. The area is now difficult terrain for enemies.

Level 4 Retainer Advancement Ability

Summon Violents
Magic, Ranged
Ranged 10
Encounter
Main action
Special

Effect: The detective summons 3 violents into unoccupied spaces within distance. On each of the detective's turns, they direct the squad of **violents** to move and use a main action.

Violent
Abyssal, Demon

Minion Ambusher

Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike
1M	7	7 | 7 | 7	1	4

Immunity: —
Movement: Climb
Weakness: Holy 1
Free Strike Damage Type: Corruption

Might	Agility	Reason	Intuition	Presence
+2	+3	0	-1	-1

★ **Transforming Strike**
The violent's melee free strikes deal an additional 2 damage to each adjacent enemy from whom they were hidden. The violent loses their disguise after striking.

★ **Mimicry**
The violent uses the Hide maneuver at the start of their turn as a free maneuver, disguising themselves as a a size 1M or smaller object.

★ **Soulsight**
Each creature adjacent to the violent can't be hidden from them.

Level 7 Retainer Advancement Ability

Cleansing Flense
Area, Magic
5 burst
Encounter
Maneuver
Each of the detective's minions in the area

Effect: Each target moves up to their speed toward an ally. Each ally within line of effect of the detective can give one EoT or save ends effect they're affected by to an adjacent minion and end that effect on themself.
Until the end of the encounter, whenever an enemy kills a target and has P<STRONG, they receive all EoT or save ends effects the target was affected by.

Level 10 Retainer Advancement Ability

Blightwash 2d10 + highest characteristic
Area, Magic
Ranged 5
Encounter
Main action
One of the detective's minions

Effect: The minion explodes. Make a power roll, targeting each enemy within 2 squares of the target.

≤11 5 corruption damage; M<WEAK weakened (save ends)
12-16 8 corruption damage; M<AVERAGE weakened (save ends)
17+ 10 corruption damage; M<STRONG weakened (save ends)

The area within 2 squares of the exploded minion is covered in blight until the end of the encounter. Abilities used against an enemy in the area have an edge.

Level 10 Retainer Advancement Ability

Summon Gorrres
Magic, Ranged
Ranged 10
Encounter
Main action
Special

Effect: The detective summons two gorrres into unoccupied spaces within distance. On each of the detective's turns, they direct the squad of **gorrres** to move and use a main action.

Gorrre
Abyssal, Demon

Minion Brute

Size	Speed	Stamina	Stability	Free Strike
2	5	27 | 27	2	8

Immunity: —
Movement: —
Weakness: Holy 1
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might	Agility	Reason	Intuition	Presence
+4	+3	0	-1	0

★ **Gorrring Strike**
The gorrre must charge before making a strike. The target is M<STRONG knocked prone if the gorrre moved through an enemy or object other than the target during the charge.

★ **Devastating Charge**
The gorrre ignores difficult terrain while charging and destroys unattended, size 1 objects in their path. Each enemy they move through during a charge takes 3 damage.

★ **Soulsight**
Each creature adjacent to the gorrre can't be hidden from them.

Rival Summoner

Any minions that the rival can summon can be replaced with the equivalent minions available within a heroic summoner's portfolio.

Rival Summoner

Humanoid, Rival

Level 2 Elite Controller
EV 16

1M	5	60	0	5
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: —
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might 0	**A**gility 0	**R**eason +2	**I**ntuition +1	**P**resence 0

Undead Summoner
The summoner can command up to two squads of minions with a maximum of 4 minions per squad. They can only have one squad of signature minions active at any time.
At the start of each of the summoner's turns, up to three **skeletons** appear in unoccupied spaces within 5 squares of the summoner. On each of the summoner's turns, they direct the squad of skeletons to move and use a main action.

Necro Beam 2d10 + 2
Magic, Ranged, Strike
Ranged 10
Signature Ability
Main action
One creature or object

≤11 5 corruption damage
12-16 8 corruption damage
17+ 11 corruption damage; **R<2** slowed (save ends)

Call Forth
Magic, Ranged
Ranged 10
1+ Malice
Main action
Special

Effect: The summoner summons the listed number of minions for their Malice cost into unoccupied spaces within distance. If the minions are a part of a new squad, the summoner directs the squad to move and use a main action on each of their turns.

Corpse Shield
—
Ranged 10
Triggered action
Self or one ally

Trigger: The target is targeted by a strike.
Effect: If one of the summoner's minions is adjacent to the target and is within distance of the strike, they become the new target of the strike.
2 Malice: Instead of commanding an existing minion, the summoner summons a **skeleton** into an unoccupied space adjacent to the target to take the strike.

Rivalry (With All of Us)
At the start of an encounter, the summoner chooses one creature within their line of effect. Both the summoner and the creature can add a d3 roll to power rolls they make against each other. Whenever one of the summoner's squads uses a damaging ability against the creature, the creature takes an additional 2 damage.

Skeleton

Undead

Signature Minion Harrier
1 Malice per minion summoned

1M	6	2	0	1
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption 2, poison 2
Movement: Climb
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might -2	**Agility** +2	**Reason** 0	**Intuition** 0	**Presence** -2

Bonetrops
When the skeleton is reduced to 0 Stamina, their square becomes difficult terrain for enemies. The first time any enemy enters this space, they take 2 damage and end this effect.

Zombie Lumberer

Undead

Minion Defender
2 Malice for two minions

2	5	8 | 8	2	4
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption 2, poison 2
Movement: —
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +2	**Agility** -2	**Reason** 0	**Intuition** 0	**Presence** +1

Zombie Clutch
The lumberer's melee free strikes inflict **A<1** grabbed. A creature or object that starts their turn grabbed by the lumberer takes 2 corruption damage.

Death Grasp
When the lumberer is reduced to 0 Stamina, they can latch onto an adjacent enemy before being destroyed. The enemy is **M<2** restrained (EoT).

Accursed Mummy

Mummy, Undead

Minion Hexer
3 Malice for three minions

1M	5	4 | 4 | 4	2	3
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption 2, poison 2
Movement: —
Weakness: Fire 1
Free Strike Damage Type: Poison

Might +2	**Agility** -1	**Reason** +1	**Intuition** +3	**Presence** -1

Fetid Bindings 2d10 + 3
Melee, Strike, Weapon
Melee 2
Signature Ability
Main action
One creature or object per minion

≤11 3 poison damage; pull 2
12-16 4 poison damage; pull 3
17+ 6 poison damage; pull 4

Effect: A target pulled adjacent to the mummy is **M<2** weakened (EoT).

Mummy Dust
Whenever the mummy takes damage, each enemy adjacent to the mummy takes 2 poison damage.

Rival Summoner

Level 5 Elite Controller
Humanoid, Rival
EV 28

1M	5	120	0	6
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: —
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might 0 **A**gility 0 **R**eason +3 **I**ntuition +2 **P**resence +1

★ **Undead Summoner**
The summoner can command up to two squads of minions with a maximum of 6 minions per squad. They can only have one squad of signature minions active at any time.
At the start of each of the summoner's turns, up to three **skeletons** appear in unoccupied spaces within 5 squares of the summoner.
On each of the summoner's turns, they direct the squad of skeletons to move and use a main action.

Essence Steal 2d10 + 3
Magic, Ranged, Strike
Ranged 10
Signature Ability
Main action
One creature or object

≤11 6 corruption damage
12–16 11 corruption damage
17+ 14 corruption damage

Effect: The summoner summons a **skeleton** into an unoccupied space adjacent to the target.

Call Forth
Magic, Ranged
Ranged 10
1+ Malice
Main action
Special

Effect: The summoner summons the listed number of minions for their Malice cost into unoccupied spaces within distance. If the minions are a part of a new squad, the summoner directs the squad to move and use a main action on each of their turns.

Corpse Carry
—
Ranged 10
Triggered action
Self or one ally

Trigger: The target is targeted by a strike
Effect: If one of the summoner's minions is adjacent to the target and is within distance of the strike, they become the new target of the strike. The original target can shift into any square adjacent to the minion.
2 Malice: Instead of commanding an existing minion, the summoner summons a **skeleton** into an unoccupied space adjacent to the target to take the strike.

★ **Rivalry (With All of Us)**
At the start of an encounter, the summoner chooses one creature within their line of effect. Both the summoner and the creature can add a d3 roll to power rolls they make against each other. Whenever one of the summoner's squads uses a damaging ability against the creature, the creature takes an additional 3 damage.

Skeleton

Signature Minion Harrier
Undead
1 Malice per minion summoned

1M	6	3	0	1
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption 3, poison 3
Movement: Climb
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might -1 **Agility** +3 **Reason** +1 **Intuition** +1 **Presence** -1

★ **Bonetrops**
When the skeleton is reduced to 0 Stamina, their square becomes difficult terrain for enemies. The first time any enemy enters this space, they take 2 damage and end this effect.

Grave Knight

Minion Brute
Undead
2 Malice for two minions

1M	6	9 | 9	1	5
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption 3, poison 3
Movement: —
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +3 **Agility** +2 **Reason** +1 **Intuition** +1 **Presence** +2

Knight Strike 2d10 + 3
Melee, Strike, Weapon
Melee 1
Signature Ability
Main action
One creature or object per minion

≤11 5 corruption damage; **M** < 1 bleeding (EoT)
12–16 7 corruption damage; **M** < 2 bleeding (EoT)
17+ 9 corruption damage; **M** < 3 bleeding (save ends)

★ **To the Grave**
When the grave knight is reduced to 0 Stamina, they can make a melee free strike before being destroyed.

Ceaseless Mournling

Minion Controller
Undead
4 Malice for three minions

2	5	6 | 6 | 6	3	3
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption 3, poison 3
Movement: Burrow
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Sonic

Might +3 **Agility** +3 **Reason** 0 **Intuition** +2 **Presence** -1

★ **Always Crying**
At the end of the mournling's turn, each enemy within 1 of the mournling takes 2 sonic damage and can't shift until the start of the mournling's next turn.

★ **Immutable Form**
The mournling's shape can't change via any external effects.

★ **Rupture**
The first time the mournling burrows out of the ground on their turn, they can make a free strike against each adjacent enemy.

Rival Summoner

Humanoid, Rival

Level 8 Elite Controller
EV 40

1M	5	180	0	8
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: —
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might 0	**A**gility 0	**R**eason +4	**I**ntuition +3	**P**resence =2

★ **Undead Summoner**
The summoner can command up to two squads of minions with a maximum of 8 minions per squad. They can only have one squad of signature minions active at any time.
At the start of each of the summoner's turns, up to four **skeletons** appear in unoccupied spaces within 5 squares of the summoner. On each of the summoner's turns, they direct the squad of skeletons to move and use a main action.

Glimpse of the Grave 2d10 + 4
Magic, Ranged, Strike
Ranged 10
Signature Ability
Main action
One creature or object

≤11 8 psychic damage; **R < 2** frightened (EoT)
12-16 13 psychic damage; **R < 3** frightened (EoT)
17+ 17 psychic damage; **R < 4** frightened (EoT)

Call Forth
Magic, Ranged
Ranged 10
1+ Malice
Main action
Special

Effect: The summoner summons the listed number of minions for their Malice cost into unoccupied spaces within distance. If the minions are a part of a new squad, the summoner directs the squad to move and use a main action on each of their turns.

Death Ward
—
Ranged 10
2 Malice
Triggered action
Self or one ally

Trigger: The target is targeted by a strike.
Effect: The summoner summons a **skeleton** into an unoccupied space adjacent to the target. They become the new target of the strike. The original target can shift into any square adjacent to the minion.
1 Malice: Instead, the summoner summons a **zombie lumberer** into an unoccupied space adjacent to the target to take the strike.

★ **Rivalry (With All of Us)**
At the start of an encounter, the summoner chooses one creature within their line of effect. Both the summoner and the creature can add a d3 roll to power rolls they make against each other. Whenever one of the summoner's squads uses a damaging ability against the creature, the creature takes an additional 4 damage.

Skeleton

Undead

Signature Minion Harrier
1 Malice per minion summoned

1M	6	4	0	1
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption 4, poison 4
Movement: Climb
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might 0	**Agility** +4	**Reason** +2	**Intuition** +2	**Presence** 0

★ **Bonetrops**
When the skeleton is reduced to 0 Stamina, their square becomes difficult terrain for enemies. The first time any enemy enters this space, they take 2 damage and end this effect.

Zombie Lumberer

Undead

Minion Defender
2 Malice for two minions

2	5	14 | 14	4	4
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption 4, poison 4
Movement: —
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +4	**Agility** 0	**Reason** +2	**Intuition** +2	**Presence** +3

★ **Zombie Clutch**
The lumberer's melee free strikes inflict **A < 3** grabbed. A creature or object that starts their turn grabbed by the lumberer takes 2 corruption damage.

★ **Death Grasp**
When the lumberer is reduced to 0 Stamina, they can latch onto an adjacent enemy before being destroyed. The enemy is **M < 4** restrained (EoT).

Ceaseless Mournling

Undead

Minion Controller
4 Malice for three minions

2	5	8 | 8 | 8	4	3
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption 4, poison 4
Movement: Burrow
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Sonic

Might +4	**Agility** +4	**Reason** +1	**Intuition** +3	**Presence** 0

★ **Always Crying**
At the end of the mournling's turn, each enemy within 1 of the mournling takes 2 sonic damage and can't shift until the start of the mournling's next turn.

★ **Immutable Form**
The mournling's shape can't change via any external effects.

★ **Rupture**
The first time the mournling burrows out of the ground on their turn, they can make a free strike against each adjacent enemy.

False Vampire

Undead

Minion Brute
6 Malice for two minions

1L	6	22 | 22	2	8
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption 4, poison 4
Movement: Climb
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Acid

Might +4	**Agility** +2	**Reason** +4	**Intuition** +1	**Presence** +1

★ **Proboscis Strike**
The false vampire's melee free strikes have a distance of 2 and inflict **M < 3** restrained (EoT). The false vampire can move the target while they are restrained this way. At the start of a restrained creature's turn, they take 4 acid damage.

★ **Bloodthirsty**
The false vampire has a speed of 10 while a creature is bleeding within 10.

Rival Summoner

Humanoid, Rival

Level 10 Elite Controller
EV 48

1M	5	220	0	10
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Damage 2
Movement: —
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might 0	**A**gility +1	**R**eason +5	**I**ntuition +4	**P**resence +3

★ **Undead Summoner**
The summoner can command up to two squads of minions with a maximum of 8 minions per squad. They can only have one squad of signature minions active at any time.
At the start of each of the summoner's turns, up to four **skeletons** appear in unoccupied spaces within 5 squares of the summoner. On each of the summoner's turns, they direct the squad of skeletons to move and use a main action.

Strike for Me
Magic, Ranged, Strike
Ranged 10
Signature Ability
Main action
One creature or object

Effect: Each of the summoner's minions within 5 squares of the target makes a free strike against the target. The target takes an additional 5 damage for each of the summoner's squads that joined the attack.

Call Forth
Magic, Ranged
Ranged 10
1+ Malice
Main action
Special

Effect: The summoner summons the listed number of minions for their Malice cost into unoccupied spaces within distance. If the minions are a part of a new squad, the summoner directs the squad to move and use a main action on each of their turns.

Death Strikes Back
—
Ranged 10
2 Malice
Triggered action
Self or one ally

Trigger: The target is targeted by a strike.
Effect: The summoner summons a **grave knight** into an unoccupied space adjacent to the target. They become the new target of the strike. The target can shift into any square adjacent to the minion.

★ **Rivalry (With All of Us)**
At the start of an encounter, the summoner chooses one creature within their line of effect. Both the summoner and the creature can add a d3 roll to power rolls they make against each other. Whenever one of the summoner's squads uses a damaging ability against the creature, the creature takes an additional 5 damage.

Skeleton

Undead

Signature Minion Harrier
1 Malice per minion summoned

1M	6	5	0	1
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption 5, poison 5
Movement: Climb
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +1	**A**gility +5	**R**eason +3	**I**ntuition +3	**P**resence +1

★ **Bonetrops**
When the skeleton is reduced to 0 Stamina, their square becomes difficult terrain for enemies. The first time any enemy enters this space, they take 2 damage and end this effect.

Grave Knight

Undead

Minion Brute
2 Malice for two minions

1M	6	15 | 15	1	5
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption 5, poison 5
Movement: —
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +5	**Agility** +4	**Reason** +3	**Intuition** +3	**Presence** +4

Knight Strike 2d10 + 5
Melee, Strike, Weapon
Melee 1
Signature Ability
Main action
One creature or object per minion

≤11 5 corruption damage; **M<3** bleeding (EoT)
12-16 7 corruption damage; **M<4** bleeding (EoT)
17+ 9 corruption damage; **M<5** bleeding (save ends)

★ **To the Grave**
When the grave knight is reduced to 0 Stamina, they can make a melee free strike before being destroyed.

Ceaseless Mournling

Undead

Minion Controller
4 Malice for three minions

2	5	10 | 10 | 10	5	3
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption 5, poison 5
Movement: Burrow
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: Sonic

Might +5	**Agility** +5	**Reason** =2	**Intuition** +4	**Presence** +1

★ **Always Crying**
At the end of the mournling's turn, each enemy within 1 of the mournling takes 2 sonic damage and can't shift until the start of the mournling's next turn.

★ **Immutable Form**
The mournling's shape can't change via any external effects.

★ **Rupture**
The first time the mournling burrows out of the ground on their turn, they can make a free strike against each adjacent enemy.

Zombie Titan

Undead

Minion Defender
6 Malice for one minion

4	4	50	5	7
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: Corruption 5, poison 5
Movement: —
Weakness: —
Free Strike Damage Type: —

Might +5	**Agility** -1	**Reason** +2	**Intuition** +4	**Presence** +5

★ **Big Stomp**
The titan's melee free strikes **M<5** knock the target prone.

★ **Overwhelming Size**
The titan can move through enemies at normal speed. If the titan ends their turn in a prone size 2 or smaller creature's space, the creature can't stand.

★ **Flesh to Mountains**
When the titan is reduced to 0 Stamina, their space becomes difficult terrain. If a creature was prone underneath the titan when the titan is killed, they take 10 damage and are restrained (save ends).

SUMMONER ADVICE

The summoner is a specialized class that presents unique challenges for both players and Directors. This section provides a few tips and tools to help you get up to speed no matter who's in control of the skeleton horde.

For Players

You now have a piece of the Director's power in your hands! The summoner's rules assume you're familiar with the **Minions** section of *Draw Steel: Monsters*; it's useful to understand how minions are usually deployed, even if your army of minions works a little differently.

If you're familiar with and enjoy playing worker placement and real-time strategy games, you'll feel right at home with the summoner. Their playstyle revolves around high-level planning and multitasking both in and out of combat, and most of our advice here revolves around giving you easy goals to focus on while learning the ropes of the class.

Roleplaying a Summoner

A necromancer could have opinions on the ethics of raising the dead. A demonologist may be at odds with an exorcist over all the demons in the party. Storm casters and feybrights might either be naturalists or academics akin to many other spellcasters.

But what's at the core of playing a summoner of any circle? We have a few suggestions for you to think through while embodying your character:

Might of many: Summoners have a proclivity for solving their problems with more hands. Extroverted summoners tend to rally people into working together and thinking through problems collectively, whereas introverted summoners may delegate all their smaller tasks to keep their head clear for bigger problems.

Numbers focused: The summoner's wheelhouse is counting and dividing large quantities, and it can trickle into their personality. They might keep track of an ally's knockouts or inadvertently watch a merchant count their coins right in front of them.

Highly cunning: Commanding an army requires long-term goal planning, flexible strategizing, and playing your cards close to your chest. A good summoner who embodies all three may come across as secretive or deceptive. A great summoner knows how to play into that impression.

Avid collector: When they aren't maintaining their minions, some summoners kick back by maintaining a collection or ticking down some kind of checklist. It's not uncommon for some summoners to treat their portfolio of minions as a collection that they plan on filling out completely someday.

Tasks for Minions Outside of Combat

If you're looking for interesting or helpful ideas for what you can do with minions outside of fighting, consider the strengths of your portfolio. All minions can scout and send messages, but how would a demon do it differently?

Demons: Demon minions are exceptionally good at hunting for missing people, lost items, or baddies on the run. They can also be great distractions while the heroes slip into the hideout on the other side. However, demons have trouble blending into civilization and going undercover without the Shaping feature.

Elementals: Elementals are excellent scouts and guards in treacherous territory, particularly when combined with your Nature Watch feature. They can also be useful in clearing natural phenomena out of the way, burning through heavy brush, digging out a collapsed cave, or drying a path through thick, wet mud.

Fey: Pixies and sprites are hard to see and harder to catch, which makes them incredible spies and information gatherers (provided they don't lie). The fey can also deliver messages across long distances quite handily.

Undead: Not only are the undead some of the best minions for performing grunt work like carrying gear or moving debris, they're also really good at activating traps meant to kill you. Remember that the undead can go where the living and breathing cannot, including underwater, burning buildings, and gas filled caverns.

Strategy in Battle

Summoners excel at preventing damage in the same way that conduits excel at healing and recovery. Once you become comfortable with using and losing your minions, you'll find that most of your strength comes from your ability to defend the party on a moment's notice and being impossible to ignore.

The Summoner Flow

The trick to managing a lot of little moving parts is to bucket them into bigger groups. That's the basis for minion squads in *Draw Steel* and how the summoner class was made possible in the first place!

You can bucket your turn into four bigger steps until you get the hang of the summoner's intricacies:

1. **Collect resources:** At the start of your turn, collect your essence and choose where your signature minions will appear.
2. **Summon minions:** Identify what problem you're trying to solve and summon the right minions best suited for the job. If your hero can solve the problem themself, save your main action instead.
3. **Position units:** Move all the minions in each squad at once, one squad at a time. Have them surround an enemy, block off a corridor, or line themselves up so you can use minion bridge to cross the field.
4. **Execute plan:** Make each of your squads take their main action. If you saved your main action, it's time for you to act as well.

Most of the rules for the summoner were created to support this structure and typically stay out of your way until you need to reference them. And if you're struck with a cool idea for your turn, don't be afraid to break from the flow and try it out—it'll probably work!

Keep the Enemy's Attention

When you're not sure what you should be doing next, you can always fall back on **obstructing the enemy**. Some of the easiest and most effective things you can do with your army are to move a minion into position next to an ally or order a squad of minions to block a doorway. Beyond that, you have access to triggered actions to instantly summon minions in front of creatures, redirect damage, taunt enemies, pull them out of position, and plenty more.

The longer your minions can hold off the enemy, the easier it is for you and your allies to use your heroic abilities and hit the enemy while they're being overrun.

Talk To Your Allies!

The summoner can take up a lot of space on the battlefield and needs to communicate with their allies to keep their paths clear. When you join the party as a summoner, the heroes get to take on riskier or more complex stratagems, but only if you talk to one another about what you're trying to do.

If the fury charges into battle and gets in over their head, send in your minions to cover their escape. If the shadow sneaks into position behind the enemy and needs a guarantee the enemy won't move, use your minions to hold them down. You might be the conduit's last hope of soaking up just enough damage that they survive and bring all your allies back from the brink.

Heroic Abilities vs More Minions

It's natural that a summoner always wants to summon more minions. Having more bodies on the field means having more damage going out and less damage coming in. But there will be times when an enemy can use a powerful area ability and clear out your army faster than you can build it. You might also face situations where you're stuck in the middle of the fray, or contend with a time sensitive objective where your party needs to be quick on their feet.

This is where your heroic abilities come in handy! Many of your abilities allow you to pierce through tough obstacles, reposition enemies and allies, or provide much needed support in a pinch; when having more minions won't solve your problems, usually a heroic ability will.

And remember that *you already summon minions* at the start of each of your turns. Use them to create an opening for yourself, just like you would support any of your allies!

Tons of Tokens

Playing in person might be daunting with many more tokens on the table than you might be used to. Using flat tokens for minions like coins, candy, or mancala stones can help significantly with sightlines. Dice are also a good minion option if you tend to always keep a trove of them on the table.

When playing *Draw Steel* digitally, give your minion tokens a distinct shape, a simpler visual style, or a muted border color. This will help you tell them apart from enemy minions AND help the other players to keep track of the game state.

A Summoner AND A Retainer?

In addition to playing a summoner, you might be eyeing the summoner retainer as a potential follower. The summoner requires the player to pull a lot more levers to fulfill its fantasy while still operating at the same power level as other classes. The same can be said about the summoner retainer (and to a lesser extent, the summoner rival). It's a lot of work!

While summoner turns move relatively quickly, even adding a single additional character to your turn (let alone a retainer and two more minion squads) can double the length of your turn in combat, requiring a lot more energy from you and dampening your party's experience at the table.

You can still do it if the other players are okay with it! You can even play a campaign with all summoner heroes each controlling a summoner retainer if you *really* want to. We want to make sure you're aware of what you're getting into (and that you have plenty of table space).

For Directors

When did the heroes get so many new allies? Before you only had to worry about the troubadour changing details about your adventure. Now their party gets minions, too!?

Make sure your summoner players have thoroughly read through the rules of their class before reaching the table. They don't need to memorize every tiny rule, but our advice focuses on strategies and ideas to keep in your back pocket whenever you direct a game featuring one (or more!) summoners.

Summoner Story Leads

You can use any of the following story leads to build interesting encounters or a whole adventure, whether there's a summoner in the party, helping the party, or antagonizing the party:

Between the Towers: Two ancient storm caster rivals have been fighting each other from their towers for decades, crashing endless waves of elementals into the wasteland between them. If the fighting isn't quelled, a terrible dragon could spring forth from the chaos.

My Teacher's Teacher: Another member of the hero summoner's circle brings news of their student's death, the hero's teacher. The hero summoner must prove their worth to the pedagogue, or else the old summoner will kill them, too!

Symphony Necromantics: A once long-abandoned graveyard has quickly corrupted the surrounding area and grows by the day. A cult of necromancers conducts an expanding orchestra of the undead in a sickly song, and will soon complete their musical ritual, calling forth an avatar of death.

The Living Portal: A young mage is haunted by demons springing forth from their forehead whenever they fall asleep. Their hometown wants the mage to leave, while ne'er-do-wells lurk in wait for their chance to capture this power for themselves.

Trapped in the Woods: The residents of a small village nestled in the forest can't leave their home without being attacked by pixies and sprites. Rumor has it their feybright plans to bring the woods back to being a full wode.

Challenging the Summoner

The summoner seems overwhelmingly capable at first. The longer you go without dealing with the summoner's minions, the sooner you will be overrun by their army. On the other hand, focusing solely on the summoner is exactly what they want you to do and allows the rest of the party to run wild without consequences.

Remember that the enemy knows what they're doing. The mage that keeps finding more demons is a problem, but so is the juggernaut with the massive axe and the assassin they just lost track of a second ago. They need to come at the heroes with a plan and force the do-gooders to react, no matter who's in the party.

It helps to know what options you have available to counter or limit the typical summoner strategies. You need to strike a careful balance of targeting the summoner and targeting their party to ensure that the hero still gets to do what they do best without completely upending your encounters.

Entrap the Summoner

If the summoner is unable to move or becomes isolated from their allies, their minions' ability to intercept threats gets limited. Minions normally can't listen to new commands once they leave the Summoner's Range. Not only that, a summoner in immediate danger is more likely to call their minions close to them instead of controlling the battlefield.

Use Area Abilities

Damaging burst abilities and effects that create damaging terrain are some of the quickest ways to burn through a summoner's entourage. Hexer, controller, and occasionally artillery monsters have strong tools for dealing with multiple enemies without putting themselves in danger.

Conversely, the summoner's minions are particularly good at withstanding strikes that target multiple creatures—avoid treating them like heroes treat your own minions!

Fighting Minions with Minions

Enemy minions aren't built to last very long, but they can often hold the summoner's forces back just long enough to allow your other units to sneak up behind their leader. That said, some enemy minions can put a serious dent in the summoner's minions if they have a captain.

Map Matters

Draw Steel is already a game that heavily depends on interesting and varied encounter maps. The summoner's heavy reliance on positioning makes choosing good maps non-negotiable!

On larger, open maps, the summoner must maintain their position while responding to the battle on multiple fronts. Smaller maps or tight battlefields with a lot of choke points force the summoner directly into the fray, juggling between keeping themselves and their minions alive. A good mix of maps not only keeps the summoner on their toes, it prevents the experience from becoming repetitive or routine.

How Many Summoners Is Too Many?

Draw Steel supports at least two players using the same class without issue, and that includes multiple summoners. How many summoners your gaming table supports is another issue entirely.

If you plan on directing a combat-heavy adventure with mostly tight, indoor locations or lots of cliffside scaling, limit the number of summoners to one. The party will have a difficult time comprehending the encounter map when it's filled with terrain changing elementals, and adding pixies on top will cause the players to lose sight of the heroes' goals during the fight.

You won't necessarily need bigger encounter maps to play with multiple summoners, but maps with wide open areas will provide the whole party with enough breathing room to read the situation. Encounter maps with multiple floors can also be exciting, especially if the summoners coordinate their efforts between layers.

Alternate Rule: Standby Minions

The summoner is built in a way to keep the complexity of their turn in check and fewer bespoke effects to keep track of. As is, when each of the summoner's squads are filled with non-signature minions, they are unable to automatically summon signature minions at the start of their turn. This means you'll usually only have to contend with a signature minion and one unique threat, or two unique threats in limited quantities.

But if a player wants finer control over their summoner character and has a good handle on their toolkit (and at your discretion), you can use the standby minion rule. This will enable the summoner to still summon signature minions that can be converted into essence for other minions or abilities.

Standby Minions: Any signature minions you summon at the start of each of your turns during combat aren't organized into a new squad until you choose to do so as a free maneuver on your turn. While a minion summoned this way is not in a squad, they can't move or listen to commands, they don't activate any traits or effects upon death, and they are automatically dismissed at the end of your turn. These minions still count toward your maximum number of minions.

Converting Minions into Monsters

Most minions the summoner can call forth can be turned into Director-controlled enemies with a couple of adjustments to their numbers. *Draw Steel: Monsters* provides more detail about the specific characteristics and potencies you should be using for your desired level.

Number Adjustments: Summoner minion stat blocks can use the EV, Stamina, and damage values from the following charts, based on their role and level. If one of their preexisting values uses the summoner's characteristics, it can usually be replaced by the target level or the minion's own characteristics.

Number of Minions: Minion stat blocks now account for four minions, regardless of the number of minions the stat block previously summoned.

Signature Ability: Minions that don't have a signature ability can still rely on their free strikes when converted into monsters. That said, you can convert their free strike trait into a signature ability using the desired level's damage values and adding the text to the ability's effect.

Captain Benefits: Enemy minions can receive a small bonus while a captain is attached to their squad. Choose between a speed or strike damage bonus equal to the minion's power roll bonus, or use a captain bonus from an existing minion stat block.

Repeating Attacks: Minions that can make repeating subsequent attacks, such as the Iron Reaver, should be limited to one additional attack maximum.

Minion Stamina and Damage Categories by Role

Role	Stamina	Damage
Hexer	Low	Std
Controller	Low	Std
Artillery	Low	Pow
Harrier	Med	Std
Support	Med	Std
Mount	Med	Std
Ambusher	Med	Pow
Defender	High	Std
Brute	High	Pow

Minion EV and Stamina by Level

Level	EV	Low Stamina	Med Stamina	High Stamina
1	3 for four minions	3	4	5
2	4 for four minions	4	5	7
3	5 for four minions	5	7	8
4	6 for four minions	7	8	9
5	7 for four minions	8	9	10
6	8 for four minions	9	10	12
7	9 for four minions	10	12	13
8	10 for four minions	12	13	14
9	11 for four minions	13	14	15
10	12 for four minions	14	15	17

Minion Damage Values by Level

Level	Std T1	Std T2	Std T3	Pow T1	Pow T2	Pow T3
1	1	2	3	2	4	5
2	2	3	5	3	4	6
3	2	4	5	3	5	6
4	2	4	6	3	5	7
5	3	5	6	3	6	7
6	3	5	7	4	6	8
7	3	6	7	4	7	8
8	3	6	8	4	7	9
9	4	6	8	5	7	9
10	4	7	9	5	8	10

T1, T2, and T3 are the damage values at each tier of the minion's signature ability. Use the T1 result for the monster's free strike value.

Converted Minion Example

The following pixie bellringer has been converted from a summoner signature minion into a level 3 enemy minion.

Pixie Bellringer — **Level 3 Minion Support**
Fey — EV 5 for Four minions

1T	5	7	0	2
Size	**Speed**	**Stamina**	**Stability**	**Free Strike**

Immunity: —
Movement: Fly, hover
Weakness: —
With Captain: +2 bonus to speed

Might -3 **A**gility +1 **R**eason 0 **I**ntuition 0 **P**resence +2

Ringing Strike 2d10 + 2
Magic, Melee, Strike
Melee 1
≤11 2 damage
12–16 4 damage
17+ 5 damage
Effect: The next strike made against the target has an edge, or a double edge if two or more bellringers strike the same target.

Signature Ability
Main action
One creature or object per minion

Fairy Chime
Each ally within 1 square of a bellringer has a +1 to saving throws. Each enemy within 1 square of a bellringer has a –1 to saving throws.

Minuscule
The bellringer has cover while occupying a larger creature's space.

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